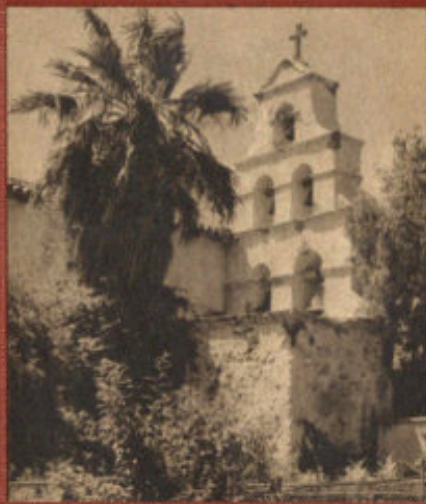


California
Missions



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MISSIONS: A GUIDE TO THE HISTORIC TRAILS OF THE PADRES



A Map Showing Location of the California Missions





California Missions

A GUIDE TO THE HISTORIC TRAILS OF THE PADRES

By KARL F. BROWN

Illustrated with seventy-eight photographs

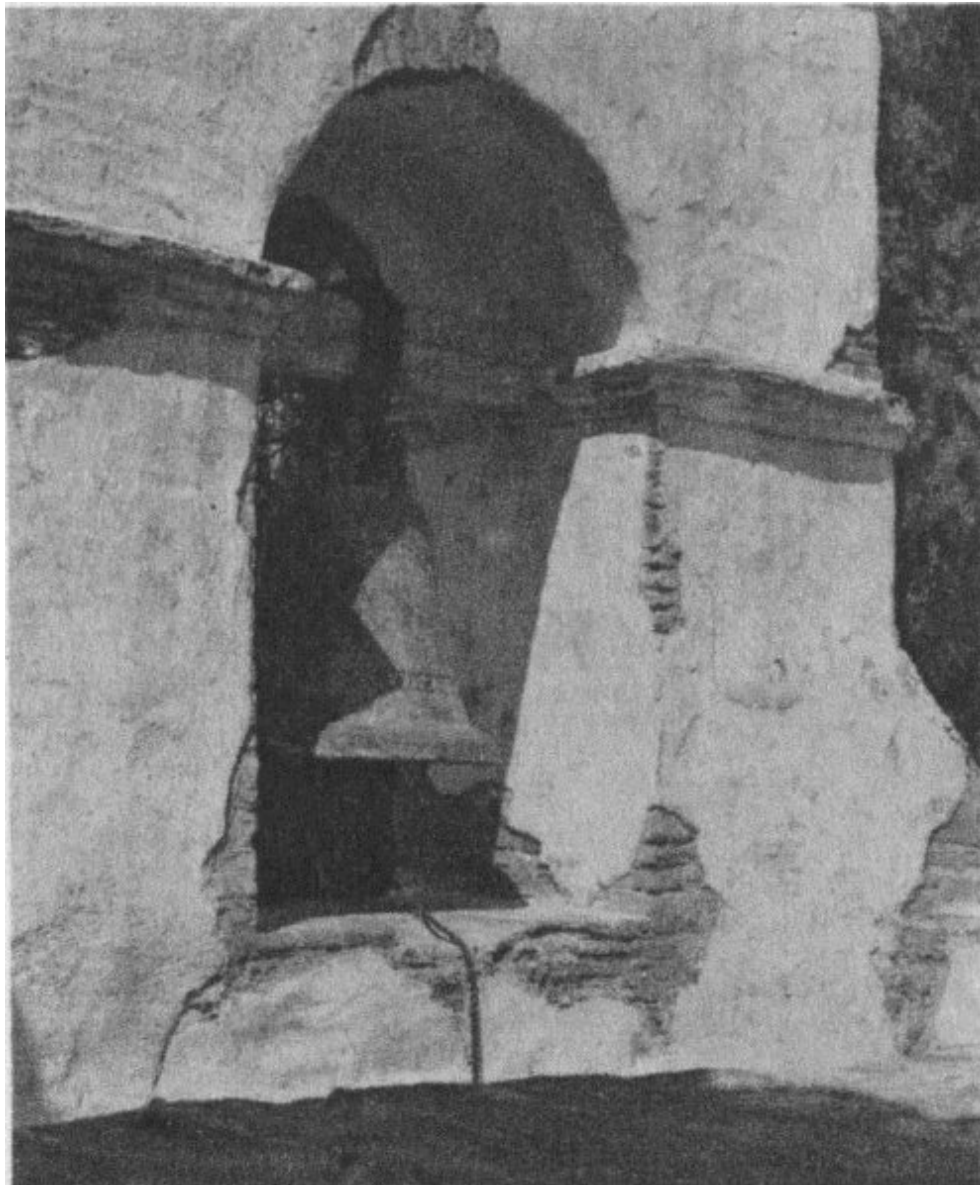
By FLOYD RAY

Foreword by

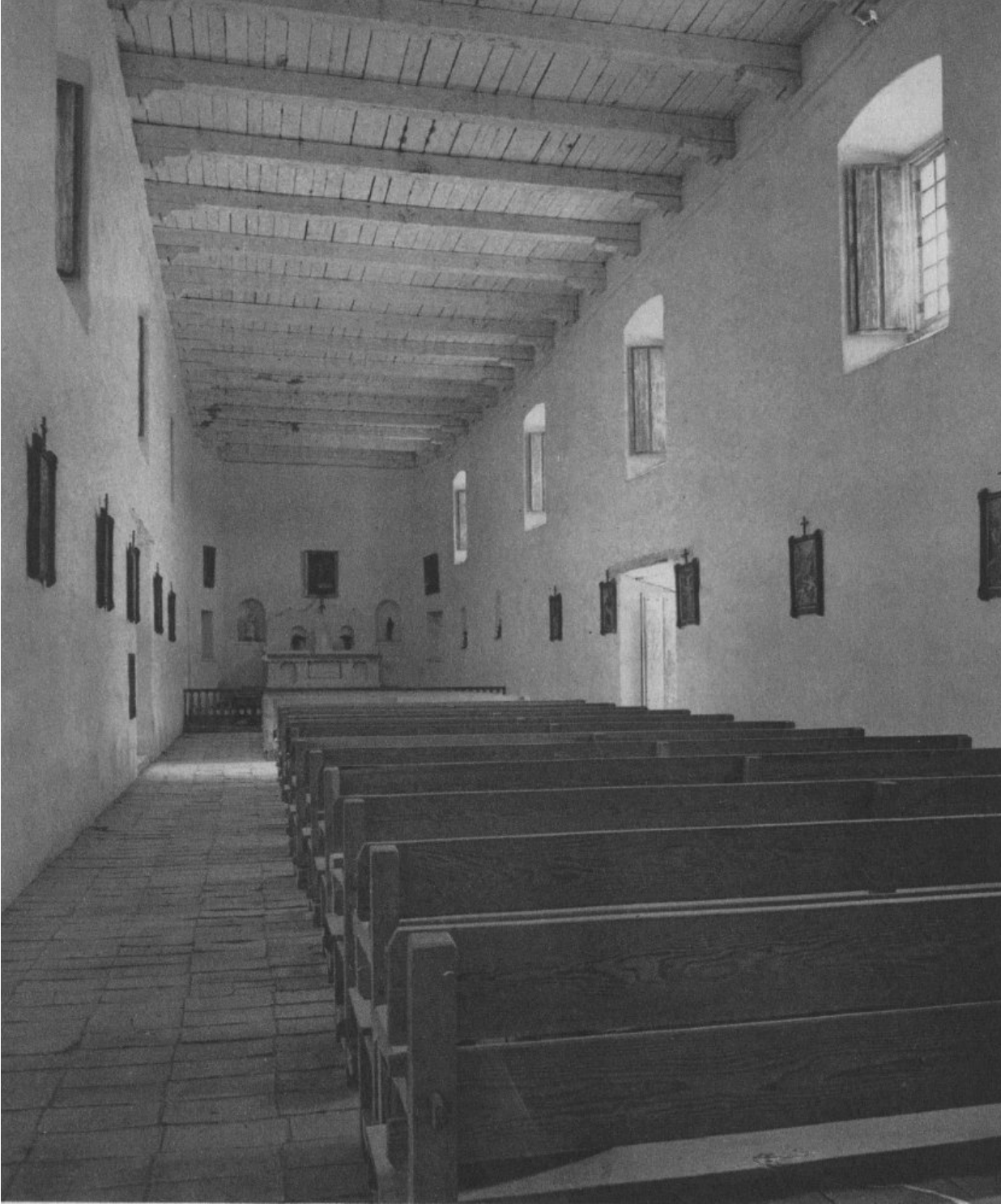
REXFORD NEWCOMB

Dean, College of Fine and Applied Arts

University of Illinois



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NEW YORK



Chapel, San Diego De Alcalá

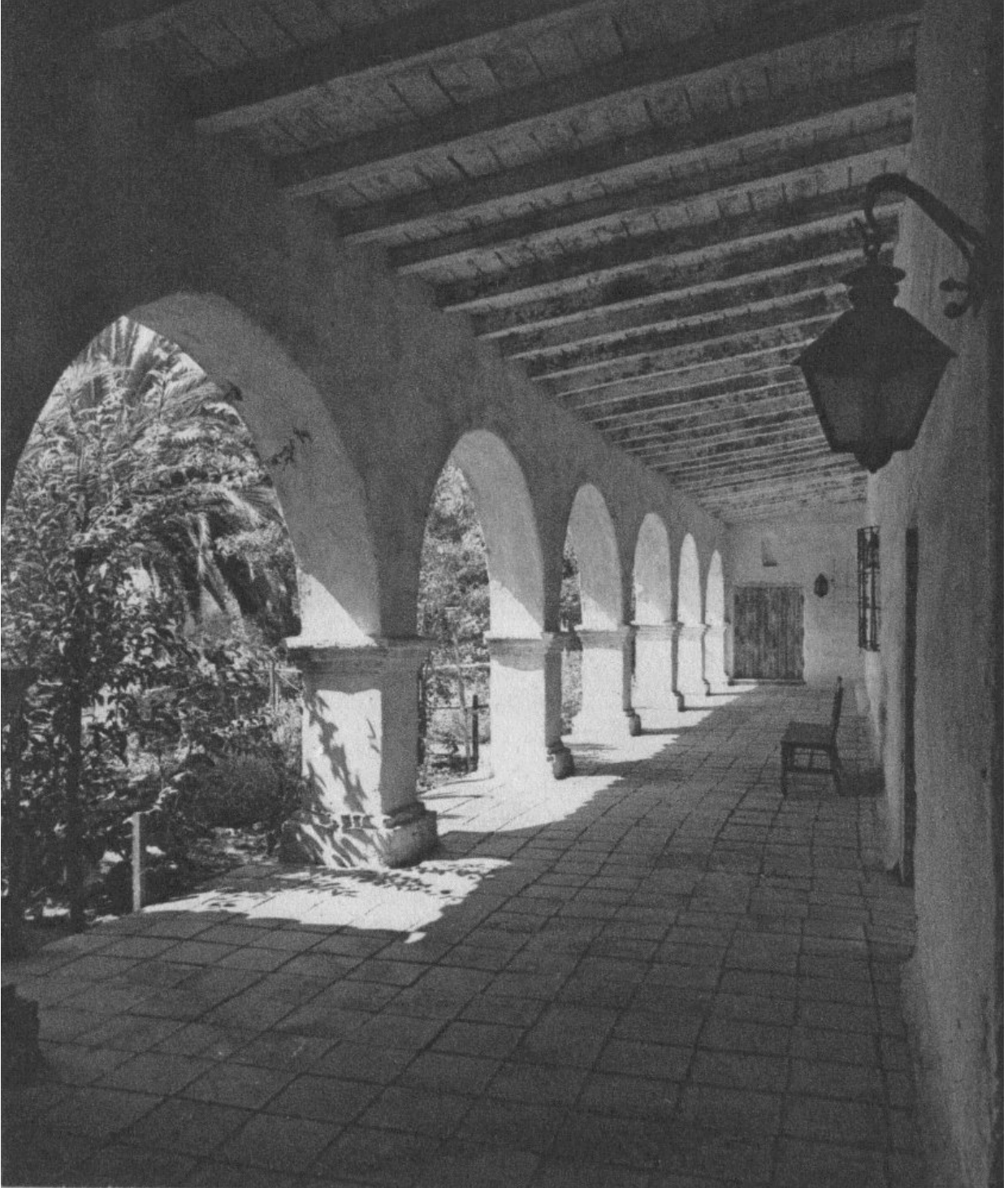


Façade, San Diego De Alcalá

Foreword

Along the strand of the Pacific between San Diego and Sonoma, the intrepid monks of the Order of Saint Francis strung that cordon of missions that were to become, as time went on, the outposts of civilization along the sunset coast of California.

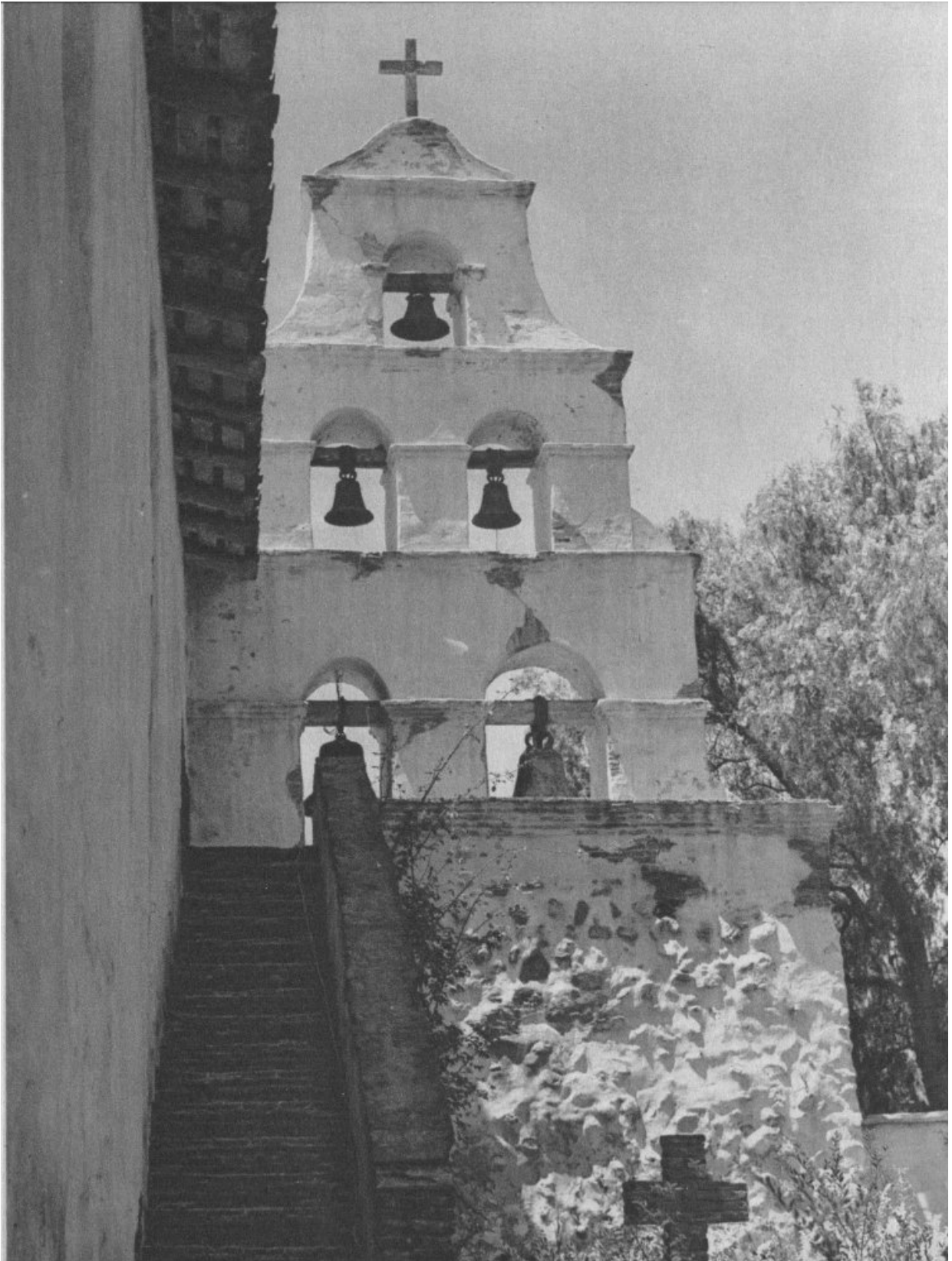
Begun in 1769, this chain of churches along *El Camino Real* was complete by 1823, and in these establishments the devoted followers of Padre Junípero Serra sought to win for Christ and the Crown of Spain devotees among the dusky inhabitants of this land. How well they succeeded may be judged when we learn that often in the more prosperous missions as many as two thousand Indians were being trained at one time. 6



Cloister, San Diego De Alcalá

And what was the routine by which these fervent priests of Old Spain hoped to convert the backward natives of the coast into God-fearing, self-supporting and self-respecting subjects of his Hispanic majesty, the king?

The system of training prescribed plenty of work accompanied by instruction in the handcrafts and Christian doctrine. To this end, each day, the morning bell assembled the Indians in the chapel for prayers and mass. Following this, breakfast was eaten, after which each went to his assigned task. At eleven o'clock dinner was eaten; then a siesta. Work, resumed at 2 P.M., continued until an hour before sunset, when the Angelus recalled all to worship. After prayers and rosary, supper was eaten, after which recreation ensued until early bedtime.



Bell Tower, San Diego De Alcalá



Bell Tower, San Antonio De Pala

This was the happy pattern of life that obtained in these picturesque missions which at once comprised the early churches, the first schools, the first factories and the work-a-day habitations of the priests and their charges. Viewed in this light these old buildings become real human documents and are therefore very precious to all interested in the beginnings of civilization within our broad land. 9

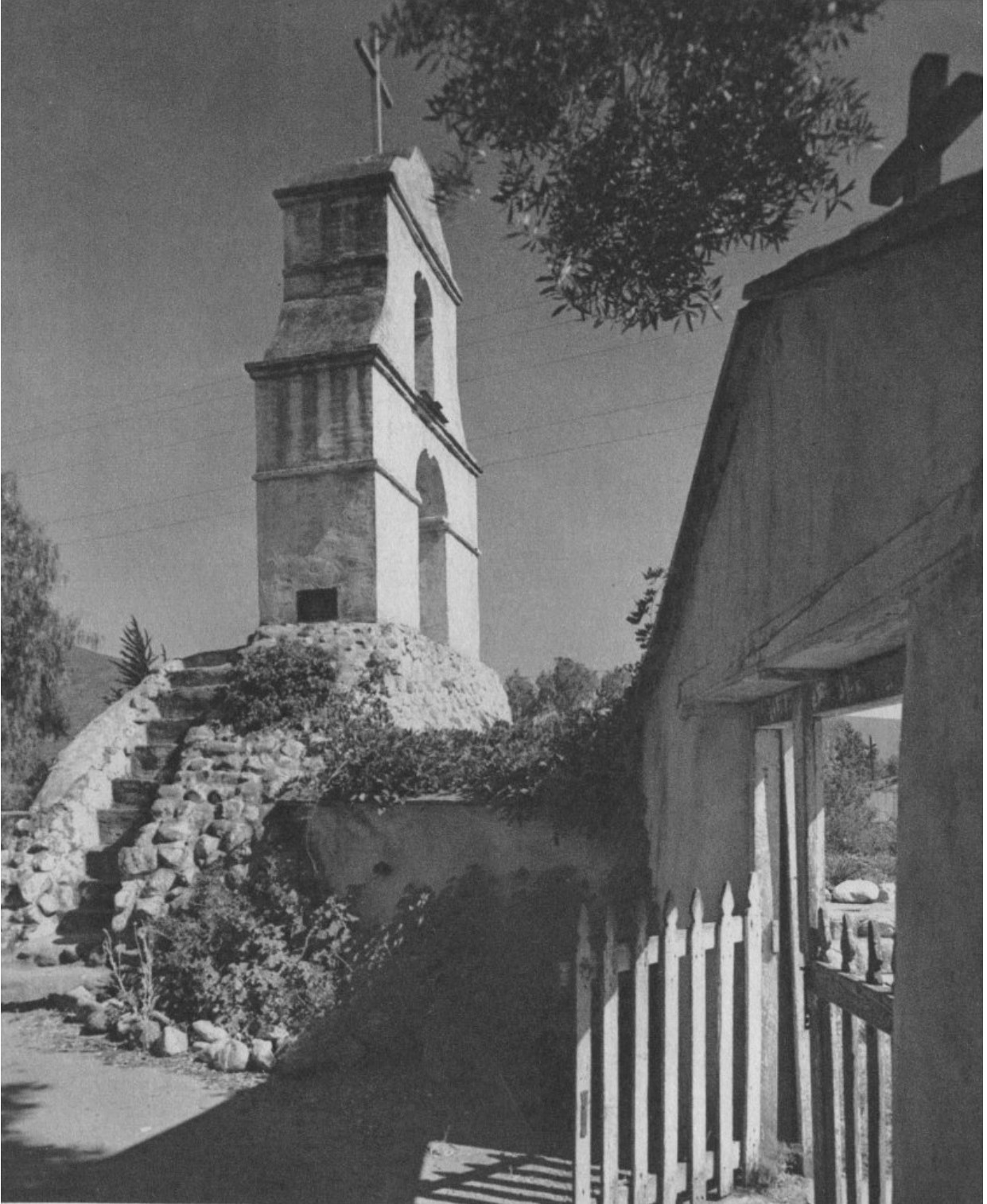


Chapel, San Antonio De Pala

Through the glamor that time and an exotic origin have cast over these old monuments, they continue to hold for us a fascination matched by that of few American structures. And, in journeying to these historic shrines, you will discover how these hard-headed priests, in sheltering their converts, created in simplicity and strength a type of architecture which considered from the standpoint of practical living, climatic background, materials of construction and ethnic significance, has rarely been equalled in any land. What a matchless artistic heritage they have left us!

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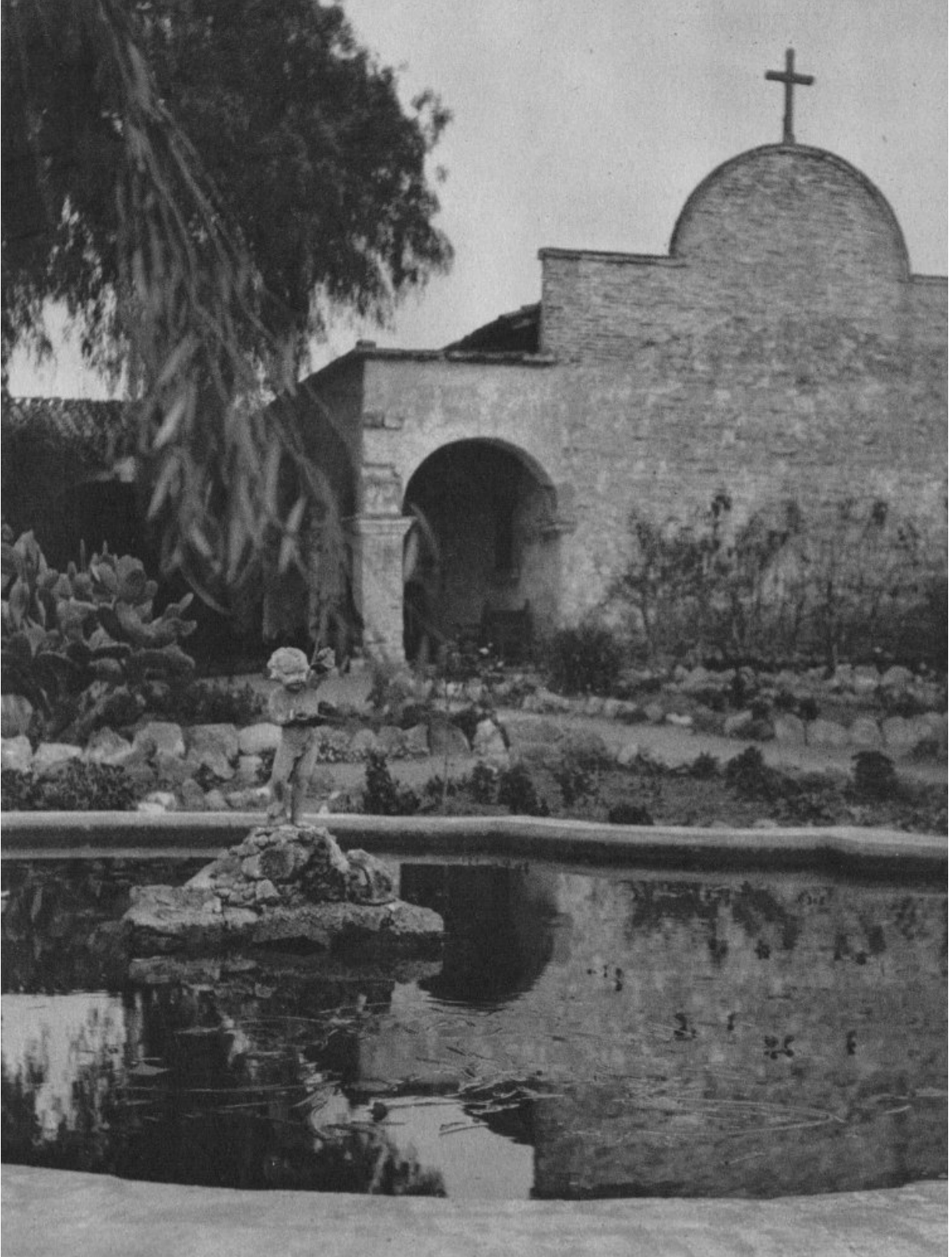
Bell Tower From Garden San Antonio De Pala



San Luis Rey



Entrance, San Luis Rey





San Juan Capistrano

California Missions

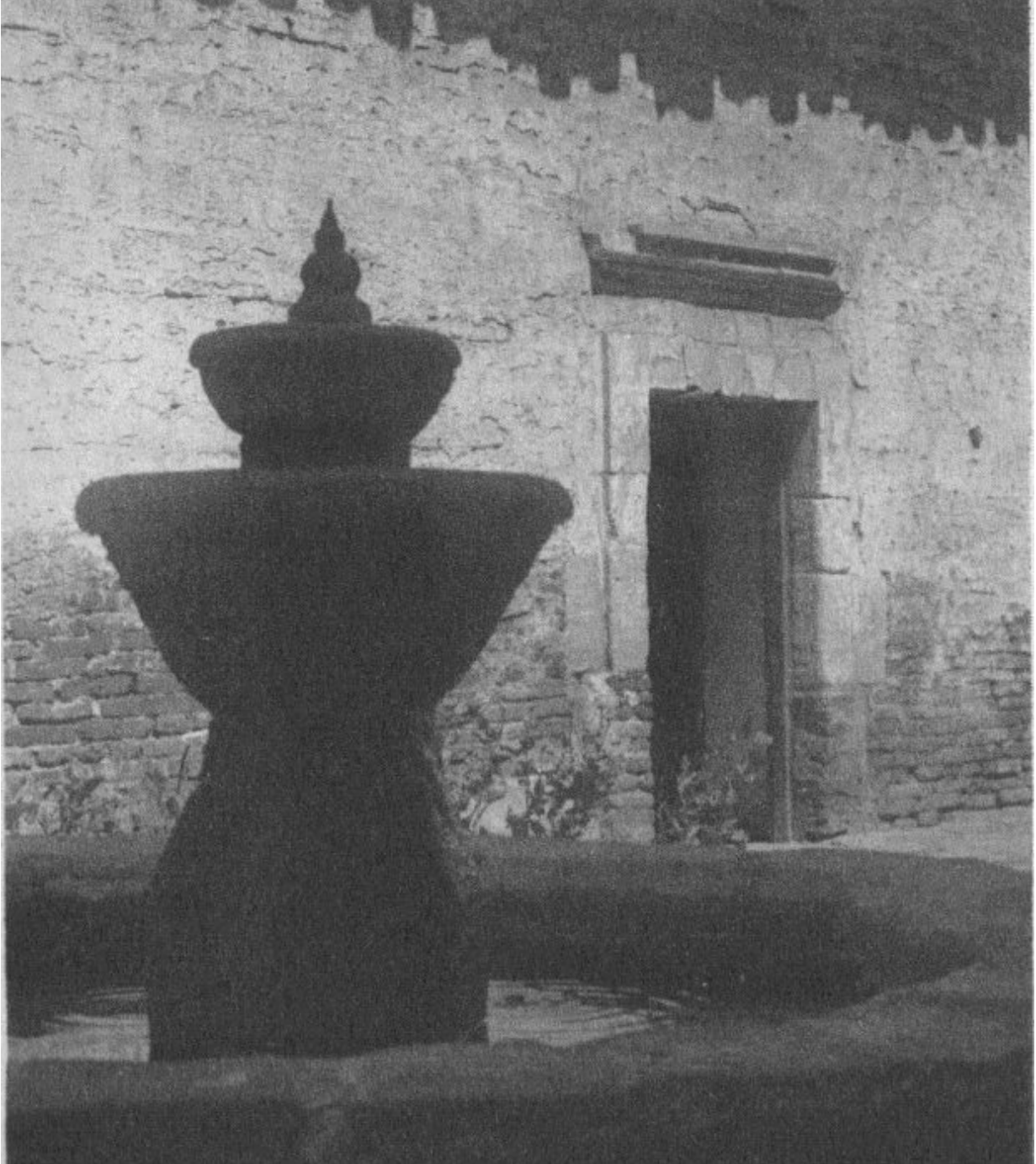
San Diego was first visited by Juan Rodriguez Cabrillo in 1542, but it was not until two hundred and twenty-seven years later that the fear that Russia or England might take possession of California induced King Carlos III of Spain to organize an expedition to colonize the land. It was in 1769 that a band of about two hundred men set out by land and sea to settle in Alta California. In the last company to come overland was Padre Junípero Serra, who, although already advanced in age, had been appointed *Padre Presidente* of the missions. This extraordinary man entered into a life of utmost hardship with a fiery enthusiasm that was never dampened throughout his life, and to him we owe the chain of historic missions that provide the only link to connect us with the early life of California and Spain. Twenty-one of these were established in California, forming an irregular line reaching from San Diego to Sonoma, and connected by El Camino Real (The Royal Road). Today the modern highway along the coast, U. S. 101, follows so closely the course of this road established by the pioneers one hundred and seventy years ago that one can easily say one is following in the footsteps of Father Serra and his companions.



Ruins of Chapel, San Juan Capistrano



Inner Court, San Juan Capistrano



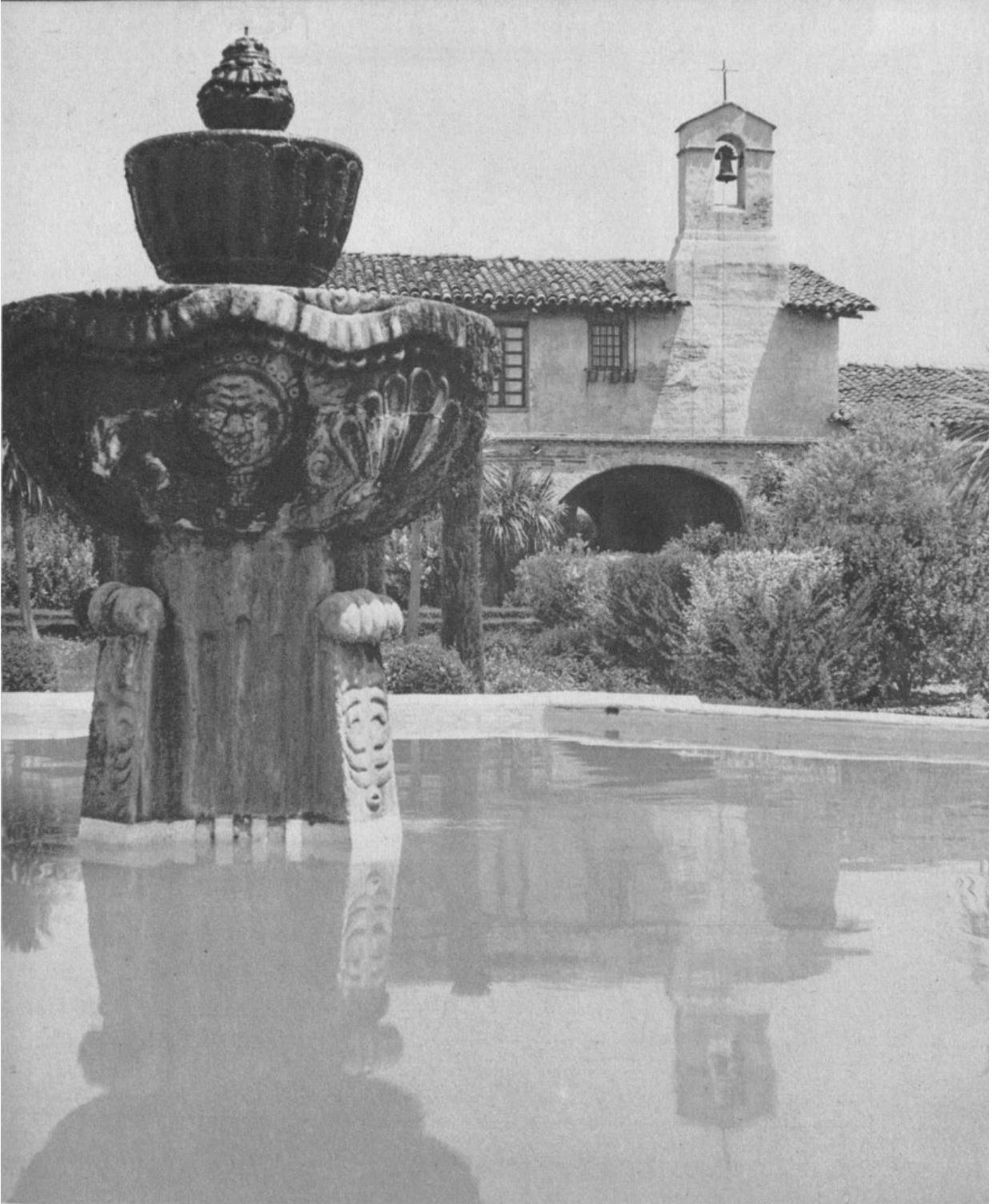
Bell Court Fountain



Mission Shops, San Juan Capistrano



Ruins of Cloister

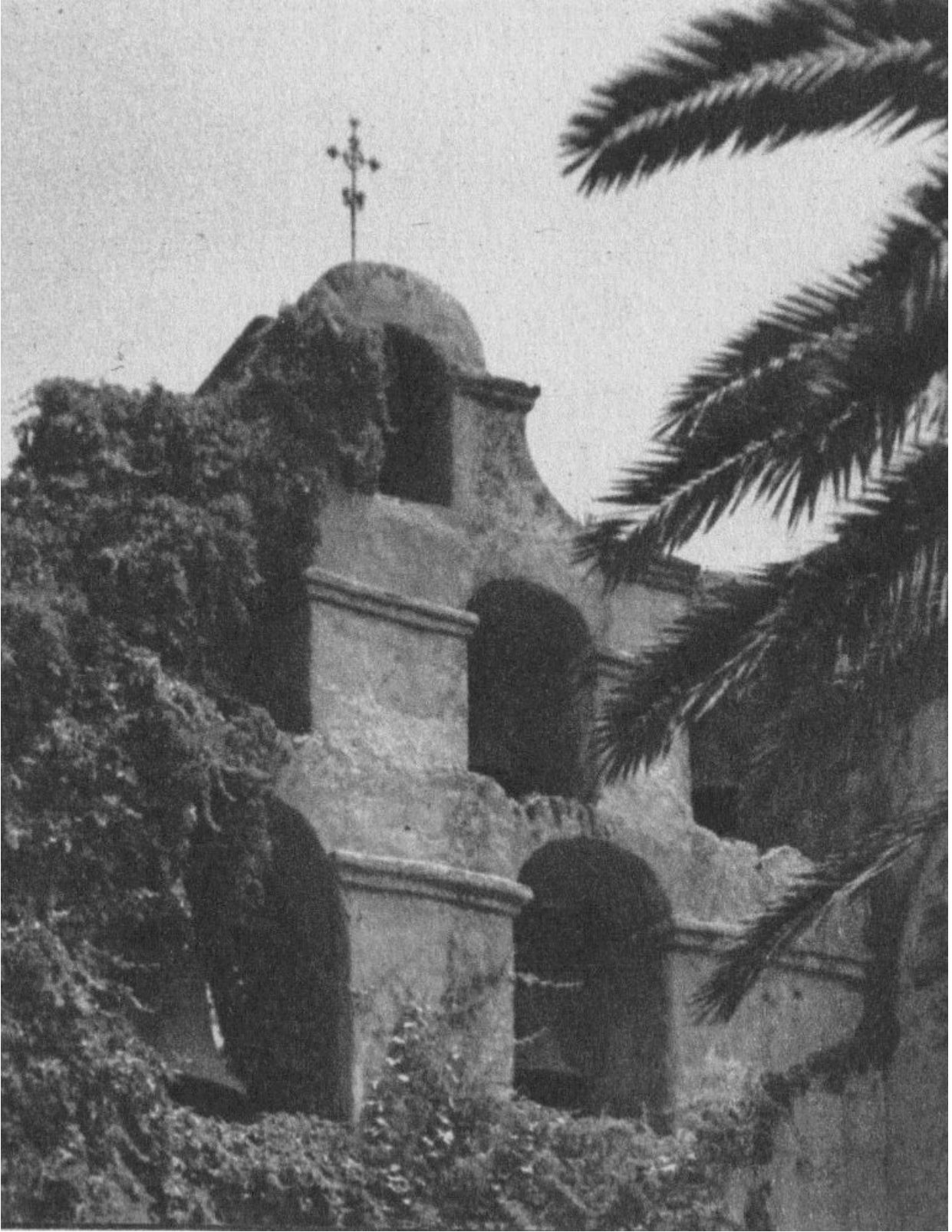


Fountain Inner Court, San Juan Capistrano

On July 16th, 1769, sixteen days after his arrival in San Diego, 18 Father Serra established the first mission in California—the Mission San Diego de Alcalá. The original site was unsatisfactory so a spot was later chosen six miles back from the ocean in Mission Valley where the present buildings now stand. San Diego was one of the wealthiest of the missions. It had extensive orchards and vineyards, irrigated by an aqueduct which brought water from the valley. Parts of the old mission dam which was twelve feet thick, may still be seen. The olive trees around the Mission form the mother orchard of all California mission olives. The whole Mission has been restored in every detail. Its belfry, one of the most magnificent of all the missions, is a three-story wall pierced by five arches in which hang the old bells.



Entrance to Church, San Gabriel



Bell Tower, San Gabriel

Four miles inland from Oceanside, in a beautiful valley, stands Mission San Luis Rey de Francia. The present buildings were started in 1811 by Father Peyri, who managed the Mission for thirty years. It is now used as a church and a Franciscan college. A feature not found in any other mission is the mortuary chapel, a small octagonal shaped room off the main chapel. San Luis Rey is typically Spanish in its architecture and while not one of the most beautiful, it has a stately magnificence that none of the other missions possesses.



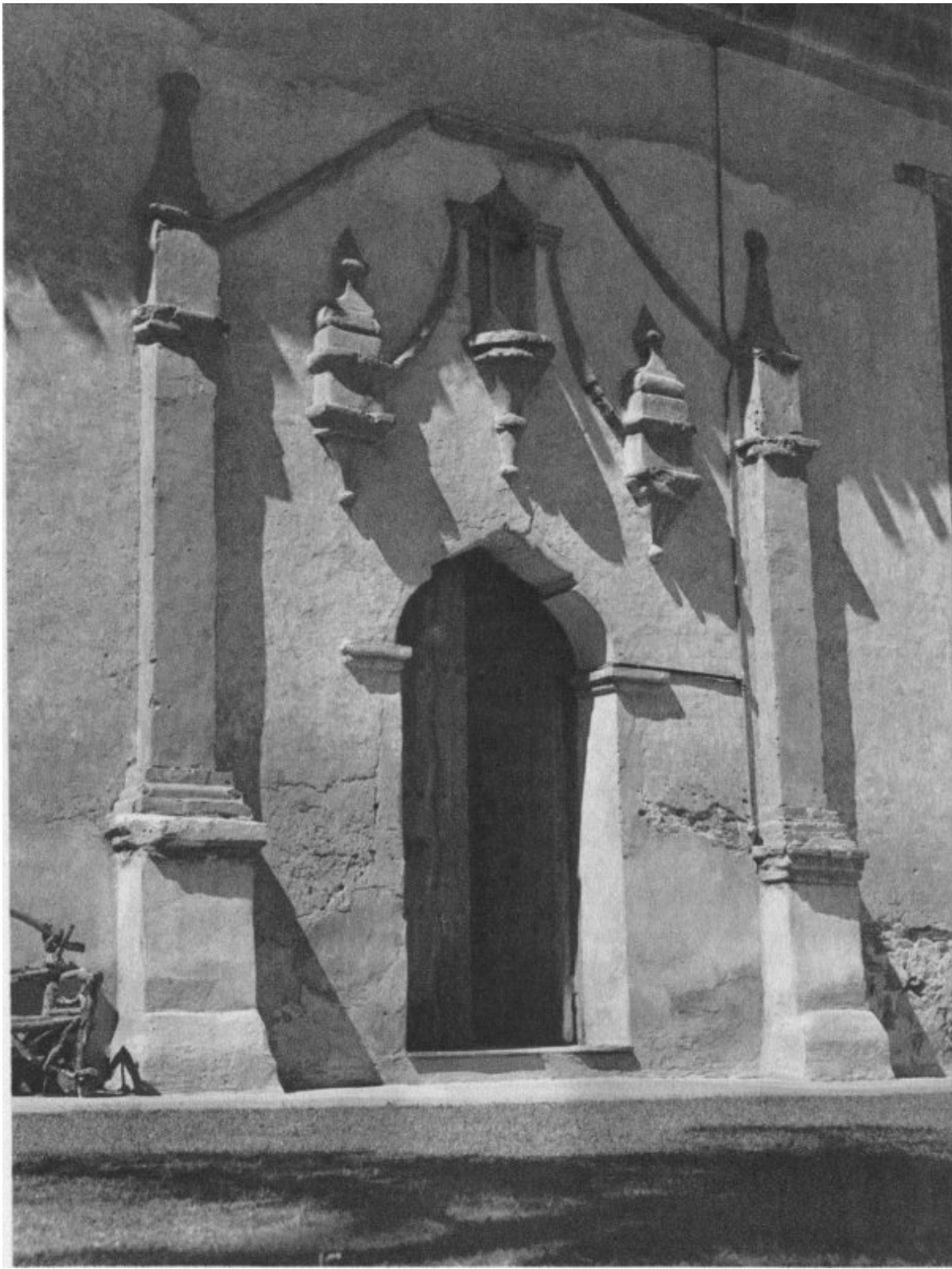
Side Entrance to Chapel, San Gabriel



Façade, San Fernando Rey

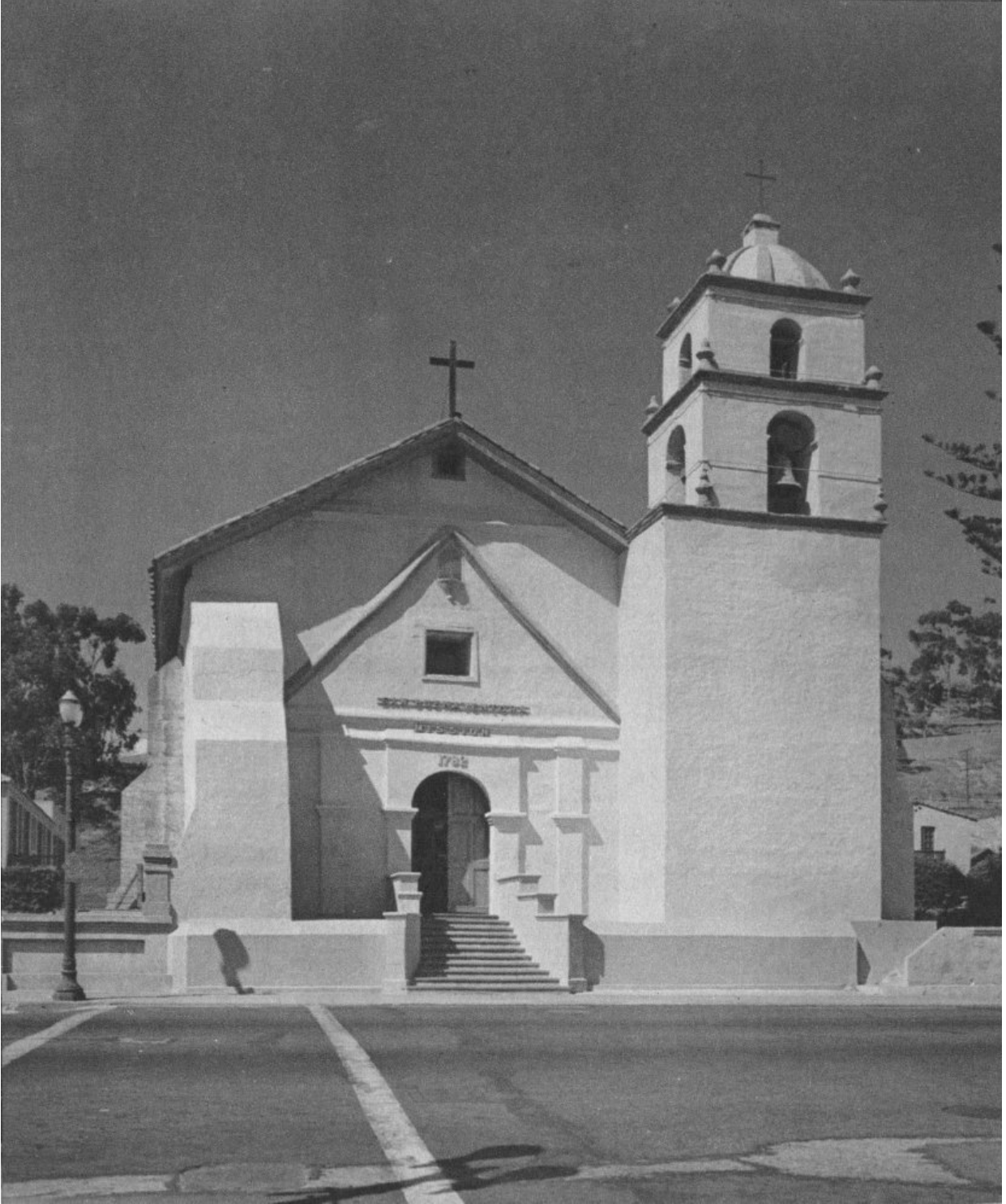


Fountain, San Fernando Rey

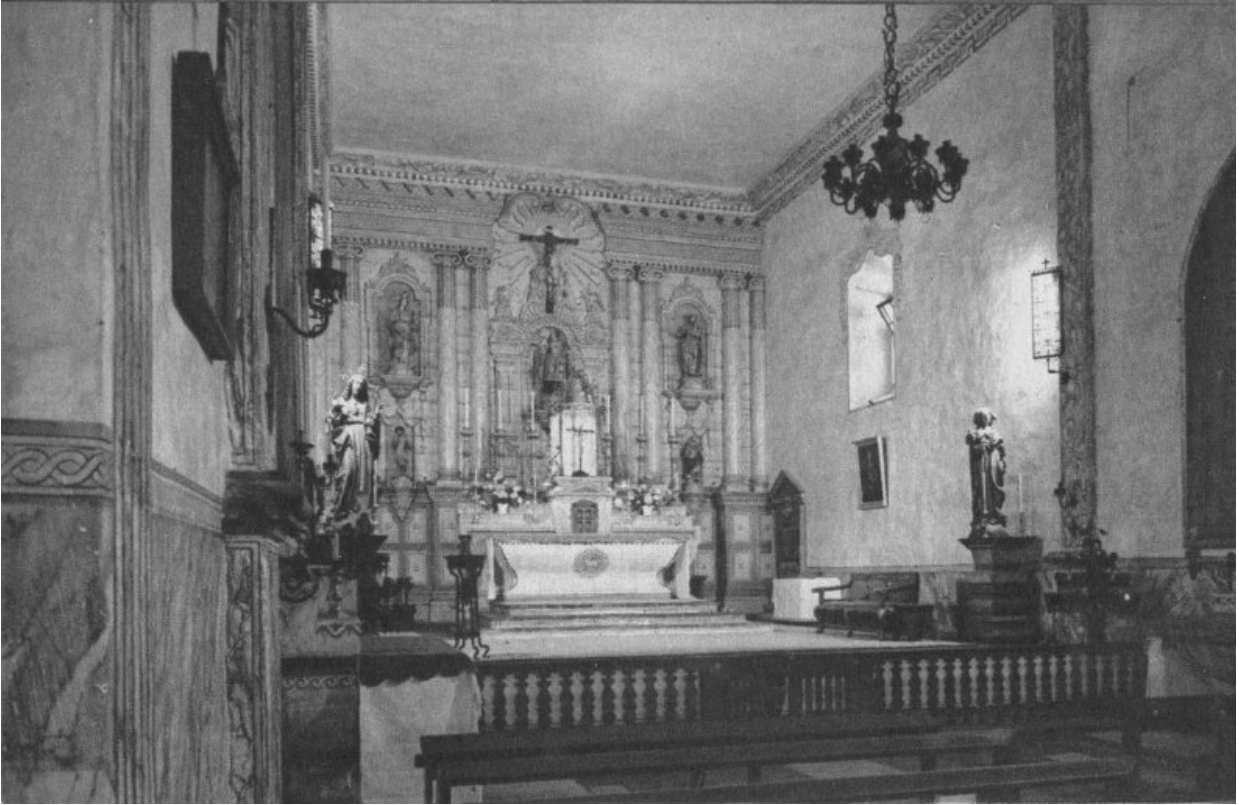


Façade, Ventura

Twenty miles inland from Mission San Luis Rey stands San Antonio de Pala, founded as an asistencia. In its chapel are Indian frescoes covered for many years with a coat of whitewash given the wall by a well-meaning padre. Its campanile, in which hang the original bells, stands in the old cemetery. Pala, nestling at the base of the Palomar Mountains, is a spot of enchanting beauty.

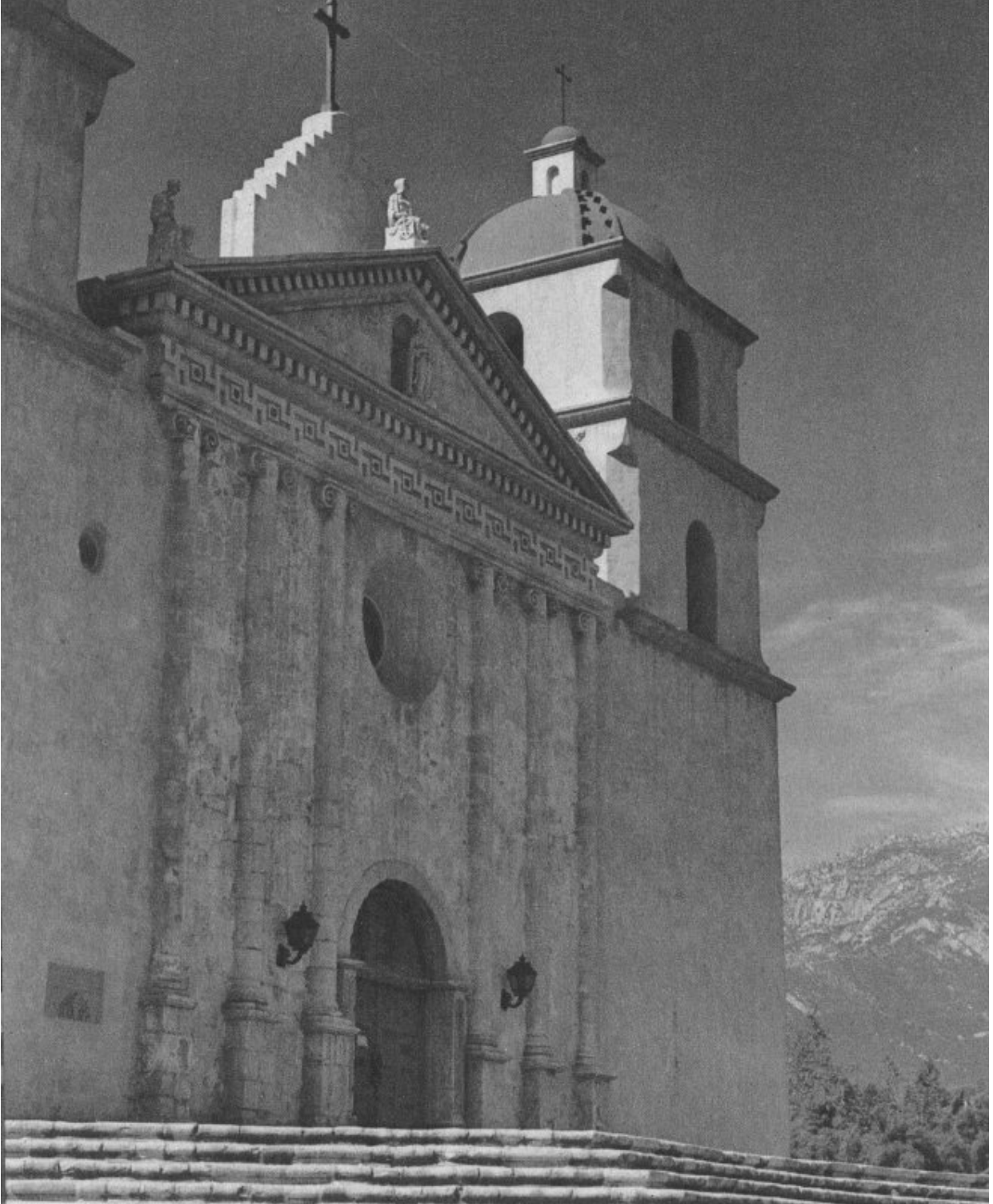


Side Door, Ventura



Chapel, Santa Barbara

The first attempt to found San Juan Capistrano was in 1775, but due to an Indian uprising Father Lasuén was forced to return to San Diego. The next year Father Serra came and established the Mission. It took nine years to build and was the largest and most beautiful of all. In 1812 there was an earthquake that destroyed the buildings and killed forty Indians who were worshipping in the chapel. All of the buildings have been rebuilt except the chapel, of which one of the seven large domes still stands in its lonely grandeur, a delight to the artist. Capistrano, elaborately decorated and artistically constructed, is sometimes called “Jewel of the Missions.”

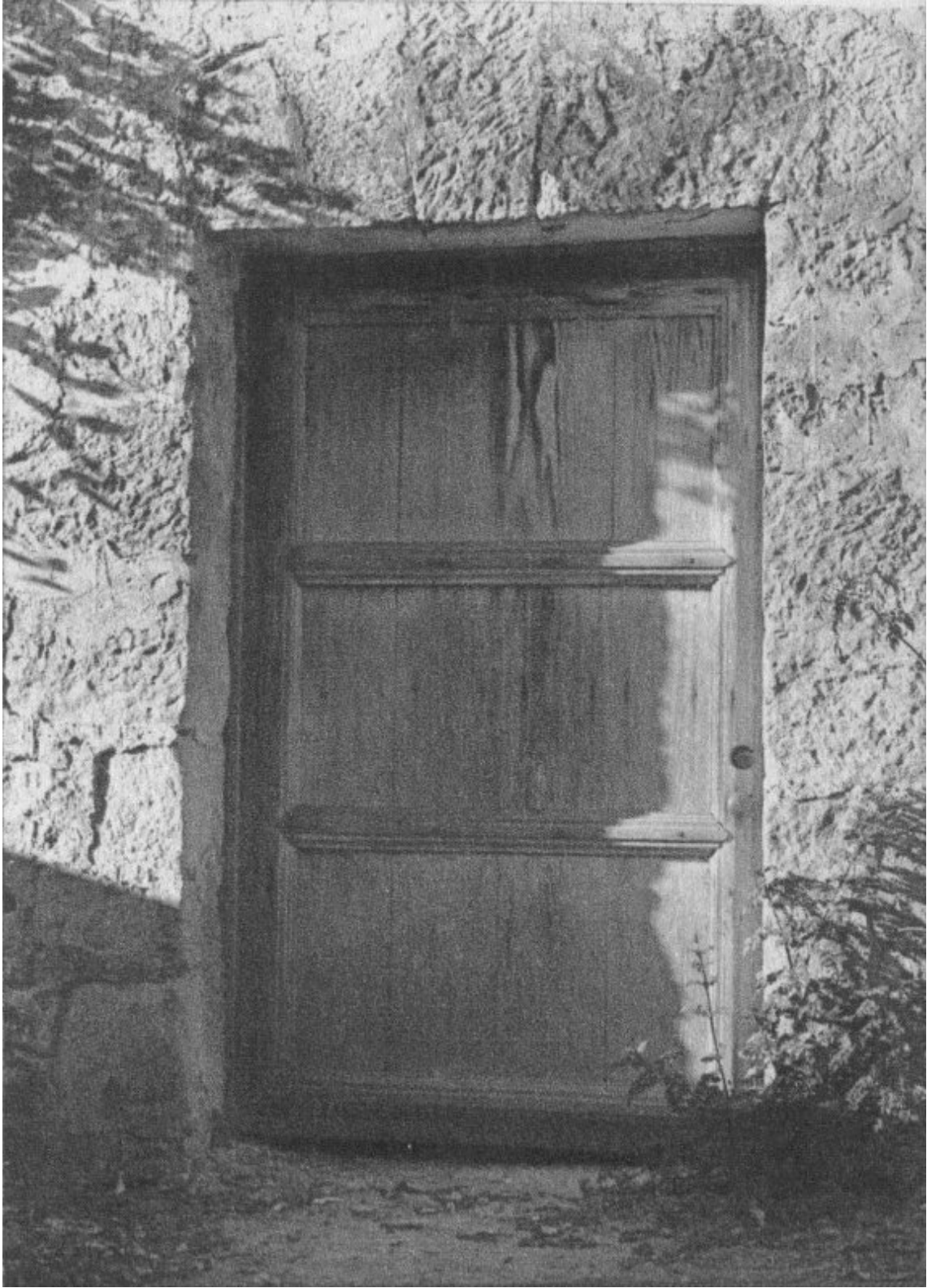


Façade, Santa Barbara



General View, Santa Barbara

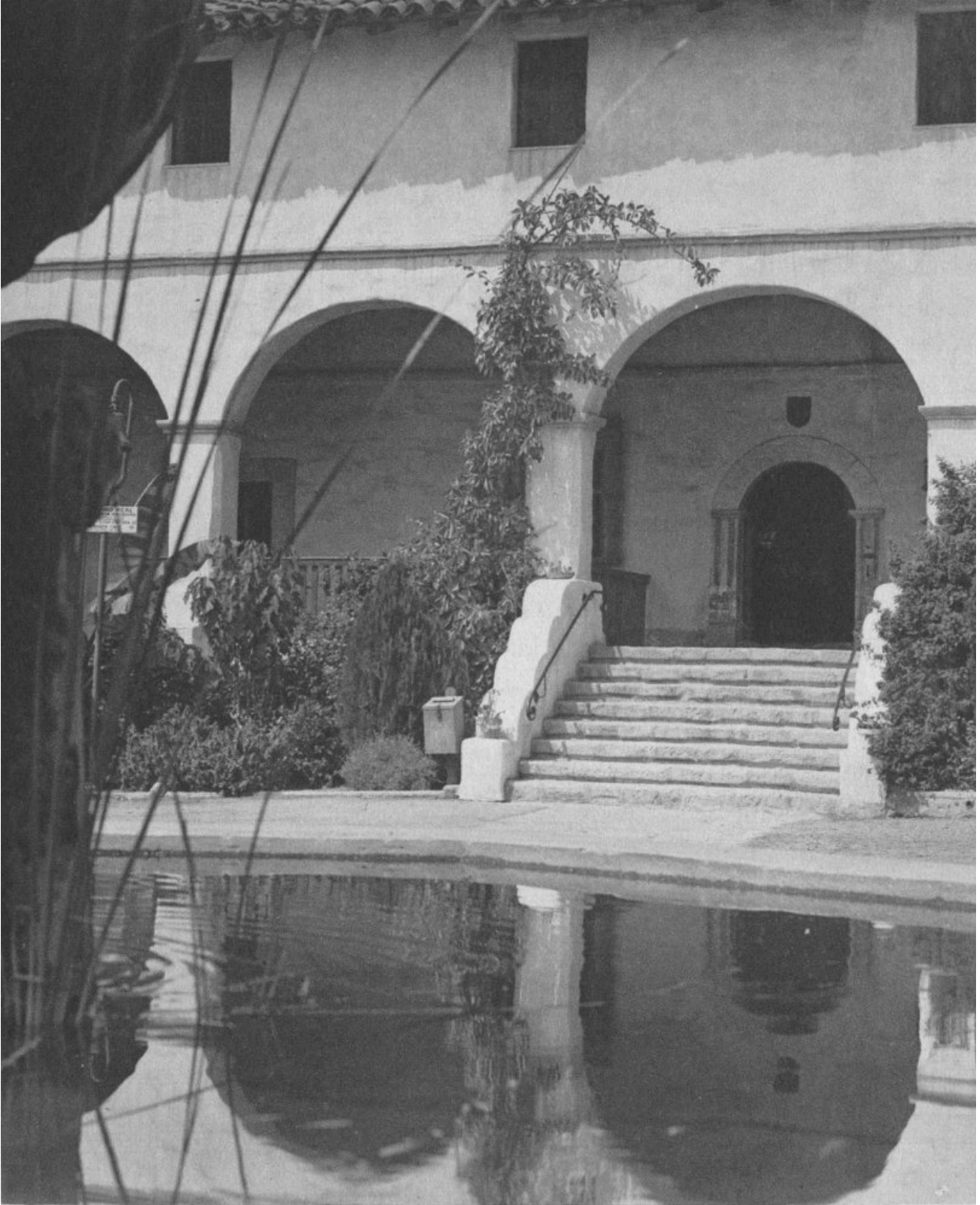
San Gabriel Arcángel was a welcomed pause in the long journey from Mexico to Monterey; it was the first stop after crossing the desert and mountains. It is distinctively Moorish in its architecture. Its high buttressed walls are stone to the windows and brick above and have an outside stairway to the choir loft and campanile. In the courtyard is one of the largest and oldest grape vines in California.



Doorway



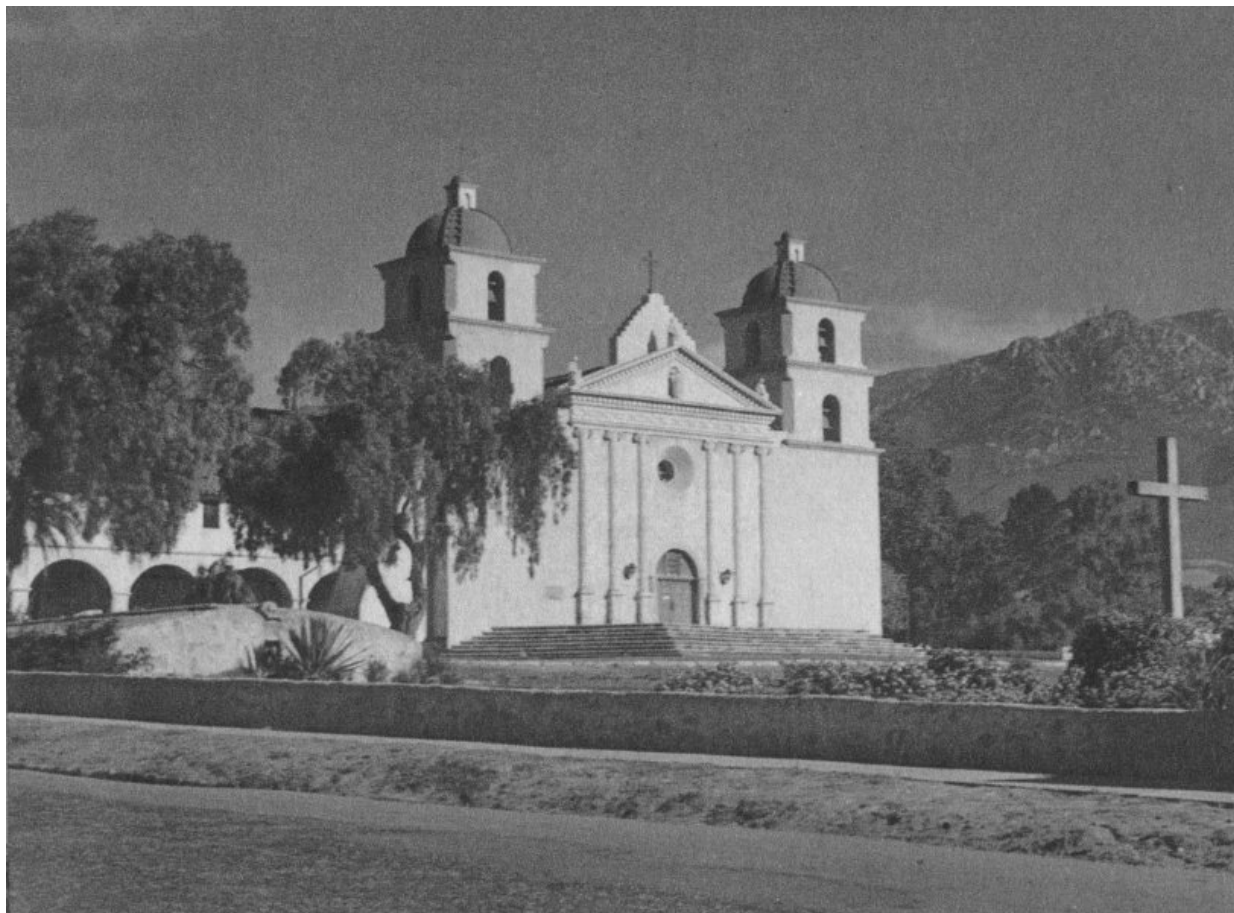
Altar, Santa Barbara



Detail of Cloister

At one time Mission San Fernando Rey de España had an Indian population of eleven hundred. Today nothing remains of the Mission but one large building. In it one can see the wine cellar and the large copper brandy still. Across the street is a large star-shaped fountain copied from one in Cordova, Spain, a monument to the artistic work of the Indians.

28



Detail of Façade, Santa Barbara

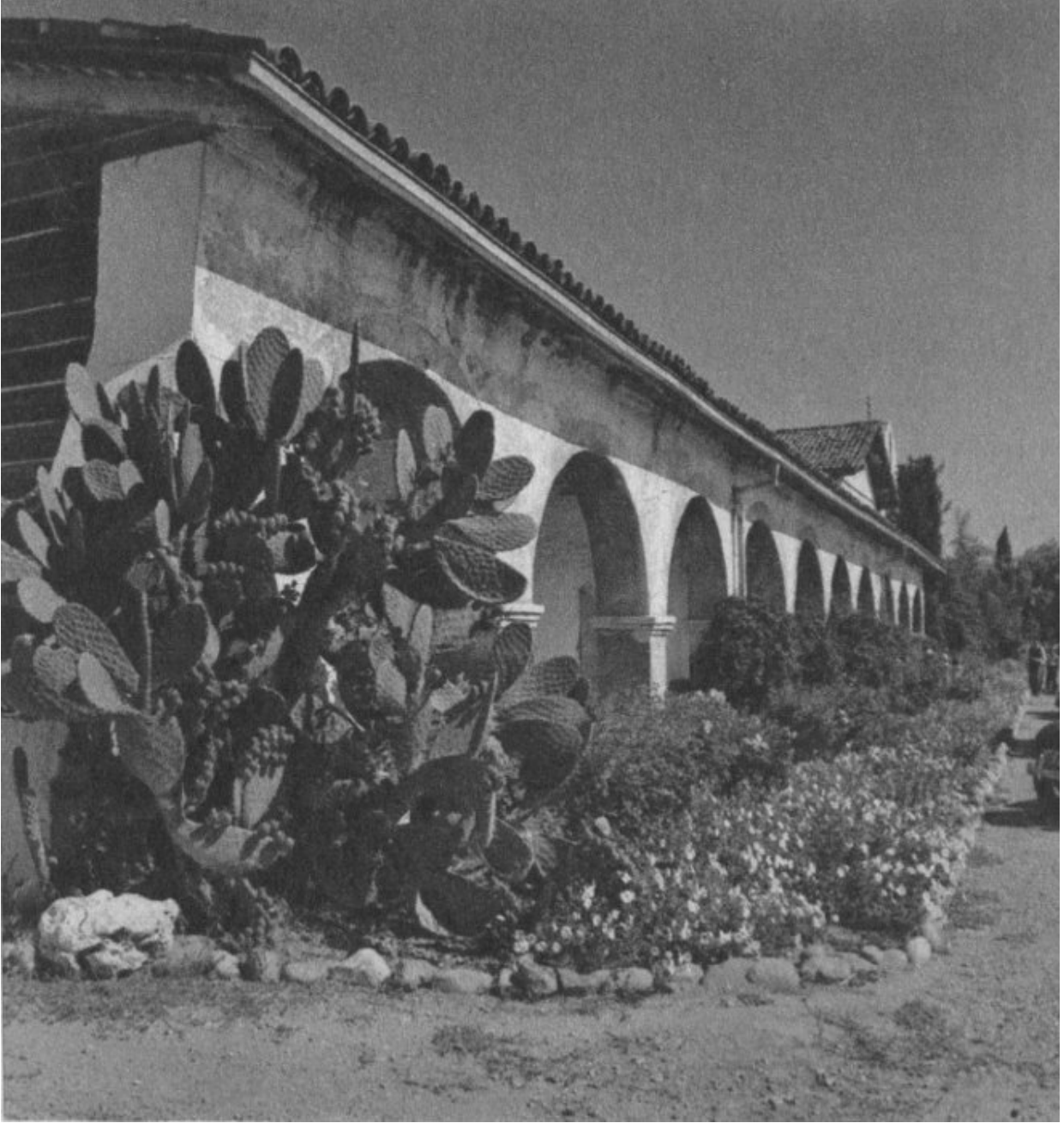
Half-way between San Diego and Monterey, Father Serra founded the Mission Buenaventura. It was the last founded by him. On a hill above the mission he planted a cross that could be seen from both land and sea. Today, a replica of the cross stands in the same place. Ventura was noted for its beautiful gardens but of these nothing remains except two tall palms. The chapel has been restored and is used daily as a place of worship.

29

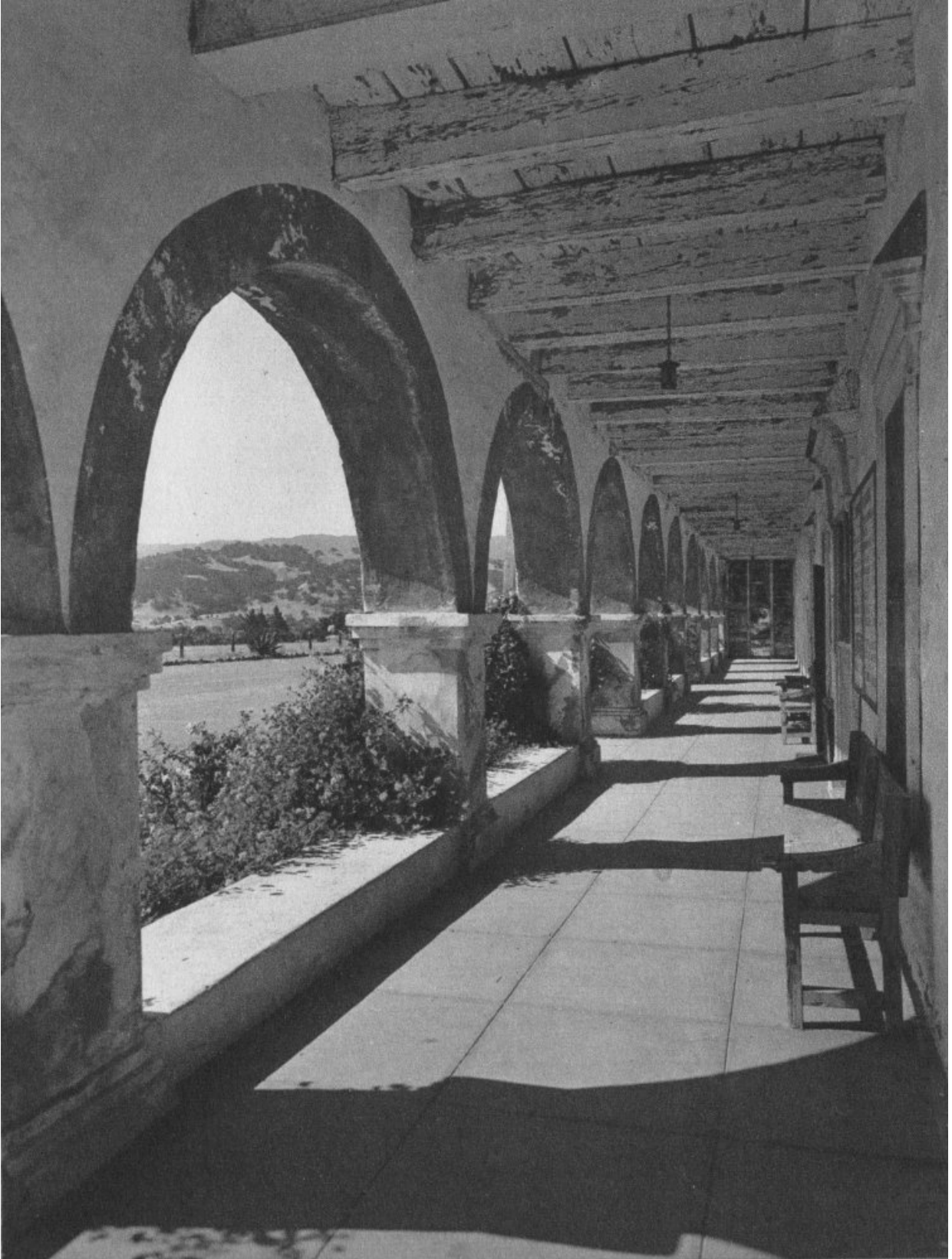




Cloister, Santa Inez



Detail of Façade



Detail of Cloister



Chapel, Santa Inez

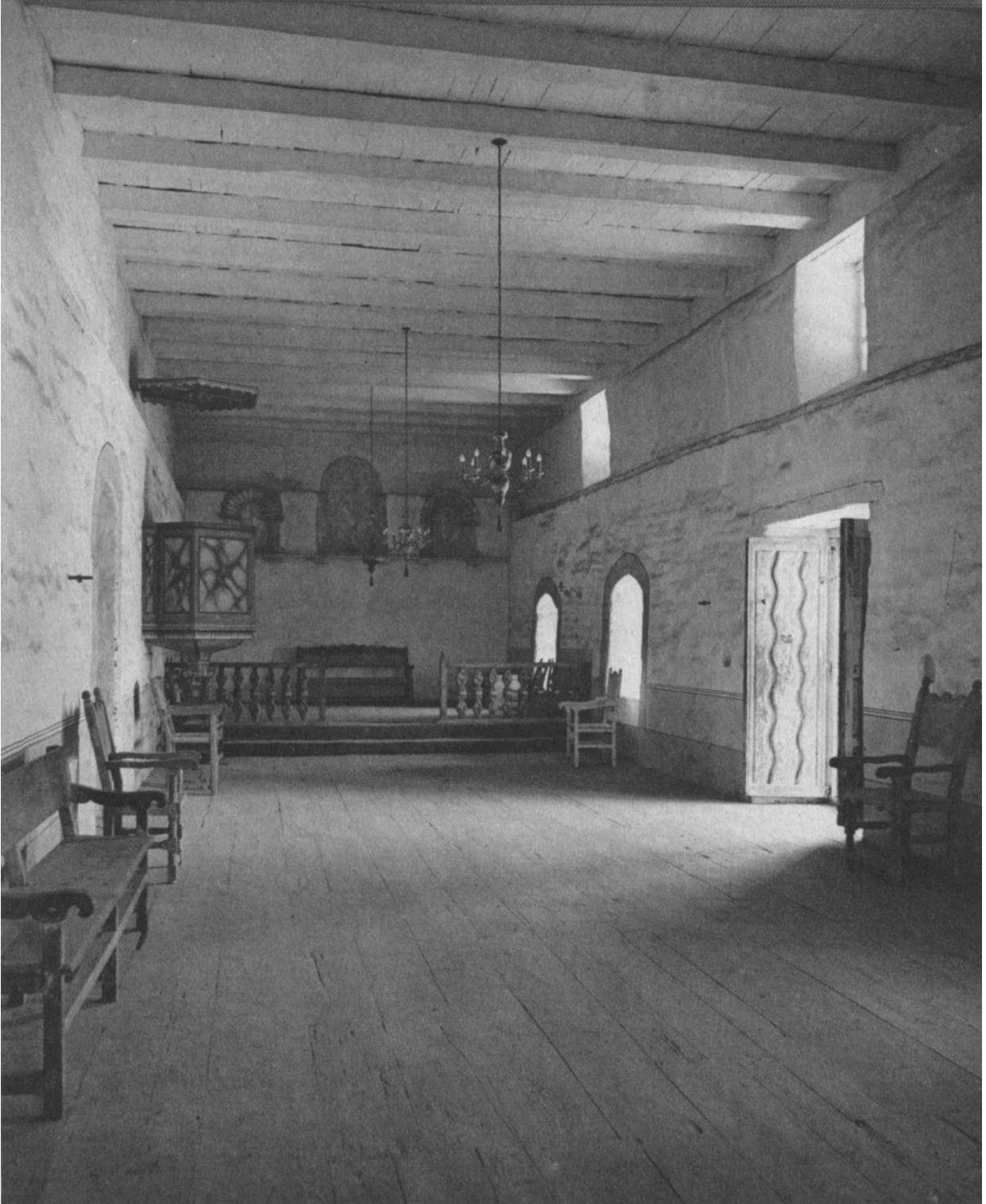
Mission Santa Bárbara has never fallen into a state of decay like its less fortunate sister missions, as it has always been in the hands of its founders, the Franciscans. Although damaged by numerous earthquakes, the last in 1925, it has always been faithfully restored. The light above the altar has never gone out, the old bells have faithfully rung the call to Mass. Its walls, six feet thick and mellowed by time, impart a lasting beauty. The bodies of over four thousand Indians lie in its tree-shadowed cemetery. In front of the Mission the trickling water from an old fountain gives one the restful feeling of the old Spanish siesta. It was at this mission that the great historian, Father Engelhardt, wrote his great book, "Missions and Missionaries of California."



La Purísima

Mission Santa Inéz was founded to convert the Indians who lived east of the Coast Range. The Mission not only suffered from earthquakes but also from an Indian uprising. Today it has been restored to its former grandeur. Its campanile with its three bells reminds one of Mission San Gabriel. In its museum is a collection of old vestments and books.

Nothing remained of Mission La Purísima Concepción but a few crumbling arches, till it was taken over by the state. Today it stands in all its former glory, faithfully restored in every detail. The Mission site was made a State park and the restoration carried out by the Civilian Conservation Corps. Purísima stands as a monument to a nation's industry, but lacks the peaceful state of religious tranquility found in the other missions.



Restored Interior, La Purisima



Detail at end of Cloister La Purisima



San Luis Obispo

It was at Mission San Luis Obispo de Tolosa that tile was first manufactured. The buildings have lost much of their Spanish atmosphere, but the interior is in a fair state of restoration. It is now the active Catholic Church of the city which was named after it. A few miles from San Luis Obispo is the Asistencia of Santa Margarita, unique in that the entire ruins have been covered over by a large hay barn. Horses and cattle quietly munch their hay through the arched window openings.

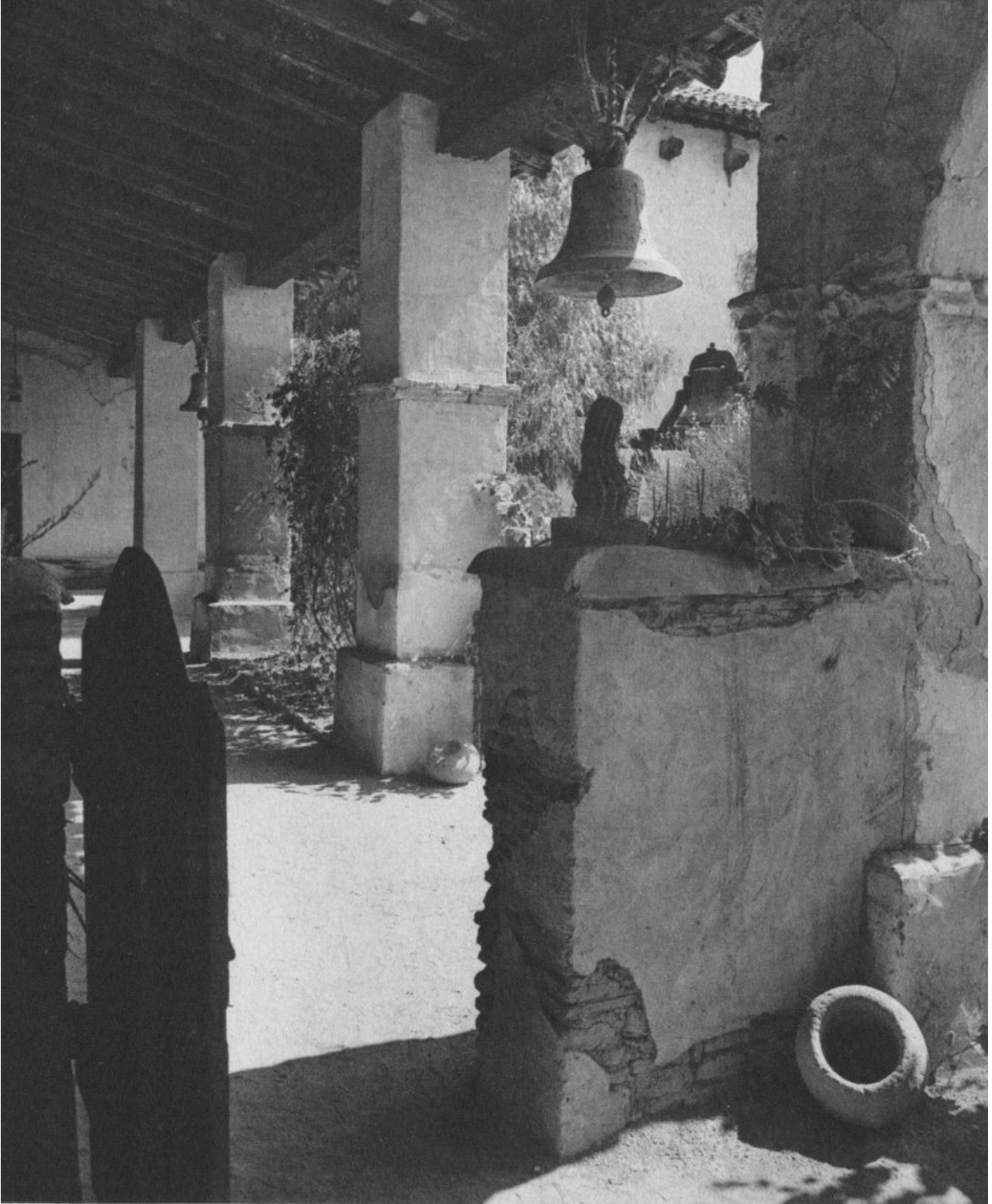


Sacristy, San Miguel



San Miguel

The very walls of San Miguel Arcángel, due to its sympathetic restoration, seem to echo the footsteps of the old padres. Inside the chapel the huge rafters, crudely hewn from logs, are painted in bright colors. The design painted on the walls by the Indians show large fluted pillars with a balcony and railing above. The floor is of burned brick, worn smooth by the tread of bare feet. Its crudely decorated pulpit and confessional are the same as the day they were built. The Mission did not have a bell-tower so the bell was mounted on a wooden scaffold. To enter the ancient edifice is to enter directly into the past.



Detail of Cloister, San Miguel



Forecourt, San Miguel



Chapel



Gate to Forecourt



Entrance to Cloister



Ruins of Arches, San Antonio De Padua



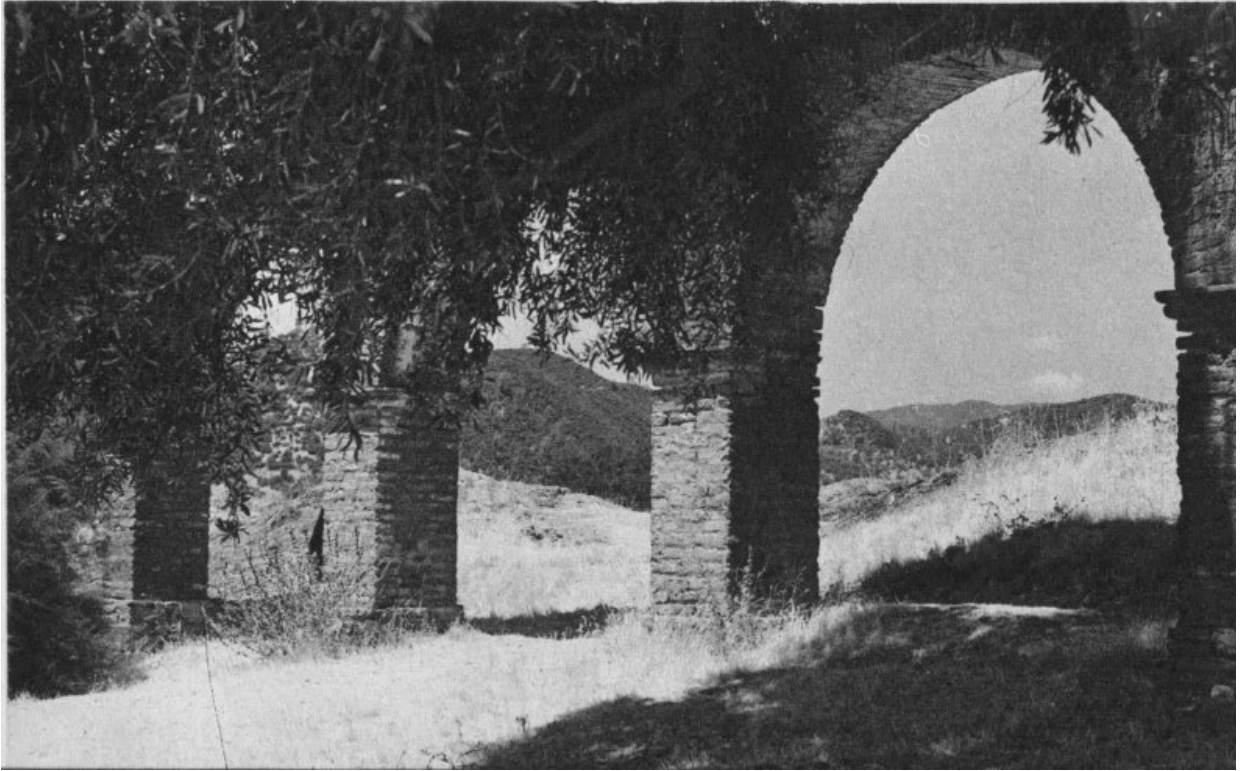
Double Arched Window

A few rain-washed adobe walls around which the wind blows constantly is all that is left of Mission Nuestra Señora Dolorissima de la Soledad. A picture of dreary desolation and aptly named, Our Lady of Solitude.

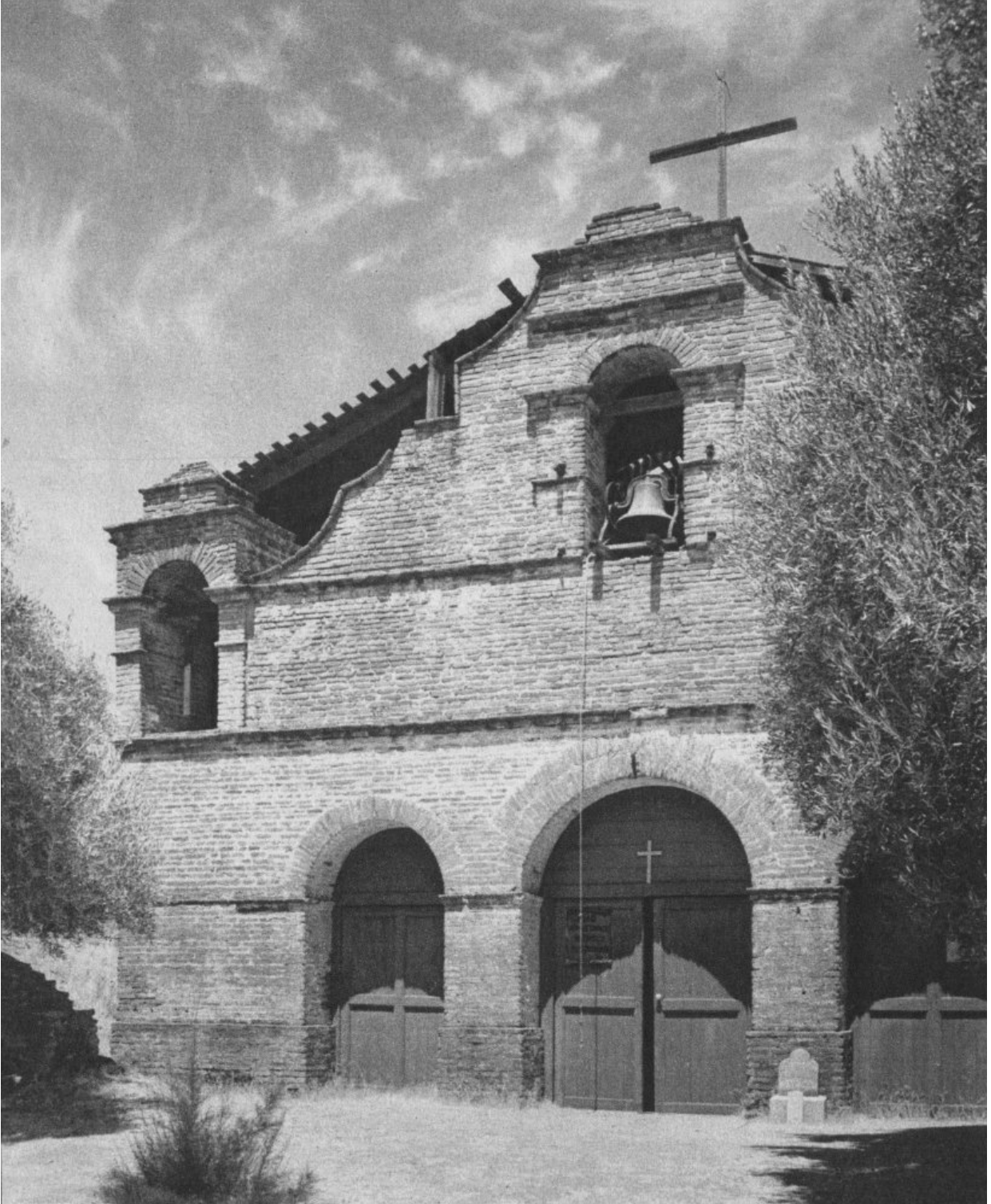
43



Side View



Arches



Façade, San Antonio De Padua



Doorway to Sacristy, San Antonio De Padua

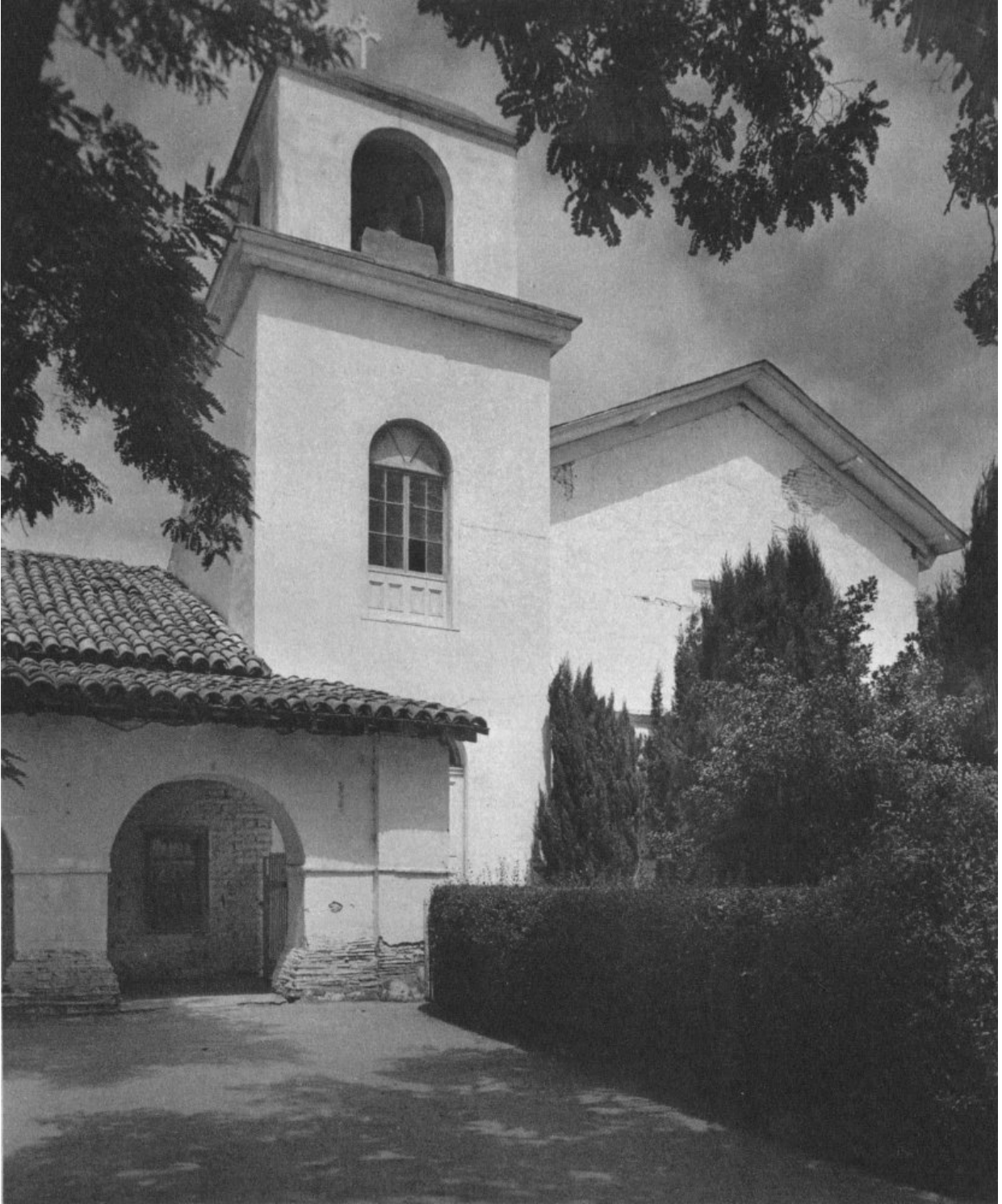
Father Serra founded his third Mission, San Antonio de Padua, in a well wooded valley. When the bells rang in celebration an Indian

appeared out of the trees, and for the first time a native was present at the founding of a mission. Its quiet surroundings are very much as they were in the past. The buildings were constructed of brick instead of adobe. Parts of a stone-walled irrigation ditch which brought water for many miles still stand near at hand.

Monterey was used as a mission for but one year and then became the Presidio Chapel. Behind the Mission is the tree under which the first Mass in California was offered. Many of the old relics of the early Church are preserved here. It is now the San Carlos Parish Church.



Soledad



Tower at San Juan Bautista

When Father Serra decided to move the Mission from Monterey he chose a site about five miles away where the Rio Carmelo enters the

sea. Here he founded Mission San Carlos Borromeo, which became the headquarters of the *Padre Presidentes* of the California missions. In its quiet sanctuary are the graves of Father Serra, Lasuén, Crespi and López, names famous in the history of the missions. Father Serra spent most of his life at San Carlos. His cell, measuring about eleven feet square, has been restored. The building is Moorish in style.



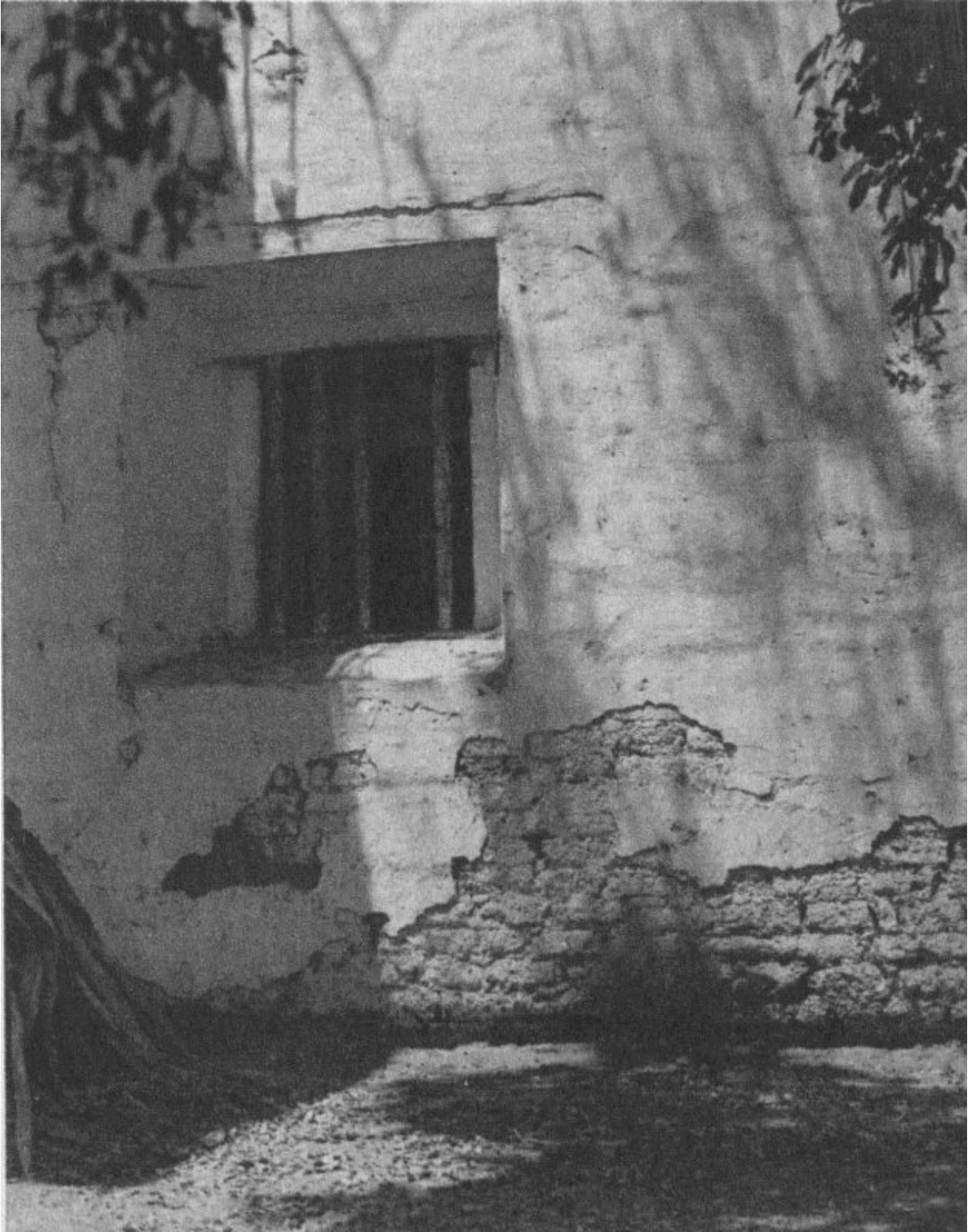
San Juan Bautista

A replica in concrete has been built of Mission Santa Cruz. It is about half the size of the original and stands on the old Mission grounds.

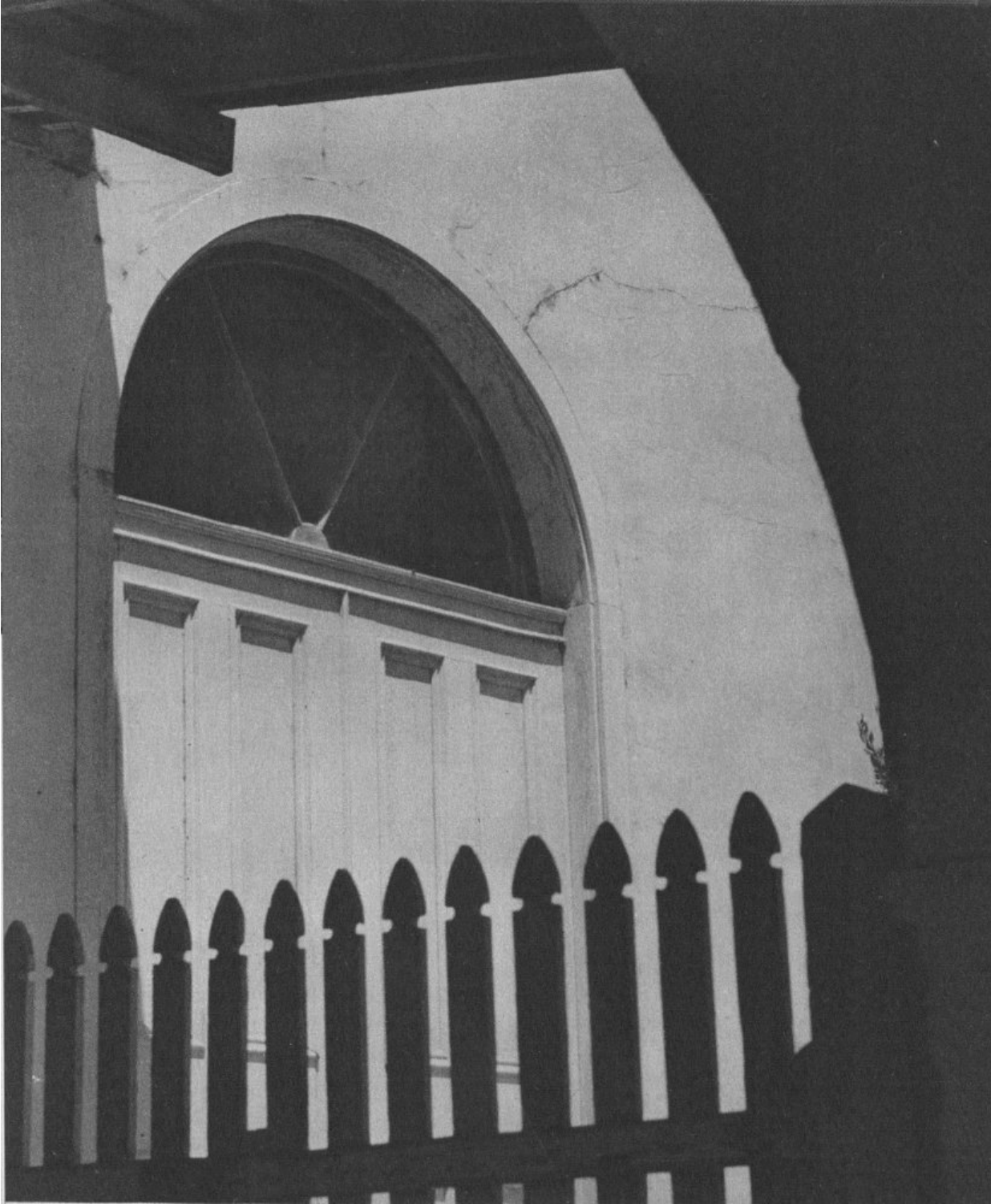
Mission San Juan Bautista stands facing the plaza in the old pueblo of San Juan. It was here that Helen Hunt Jackson began her famous story, "Ramona" and Joaquin Murrietta, the famous Mexican bandit, worshipped. San Juan saw great activity during the gold rush as it was a stage stop on the road to the mines. The long arcade that extends the whole length of the building, contains twenty arches. In the garden is a sundial, placed there by the padres. Its old cemetery is in an olive grove whose trees cast fantastic shadows on the time worn headstones.



Cloister



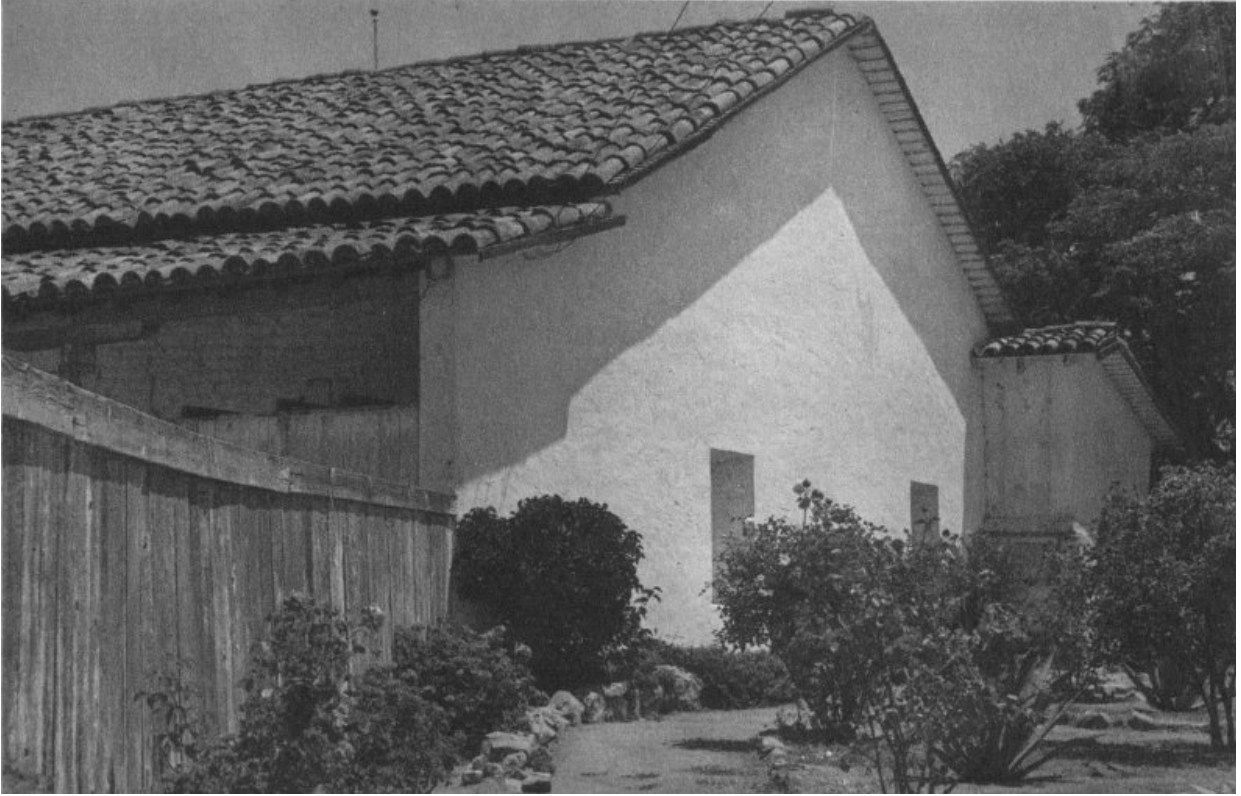
Window



Doorway at San Juan Bautista



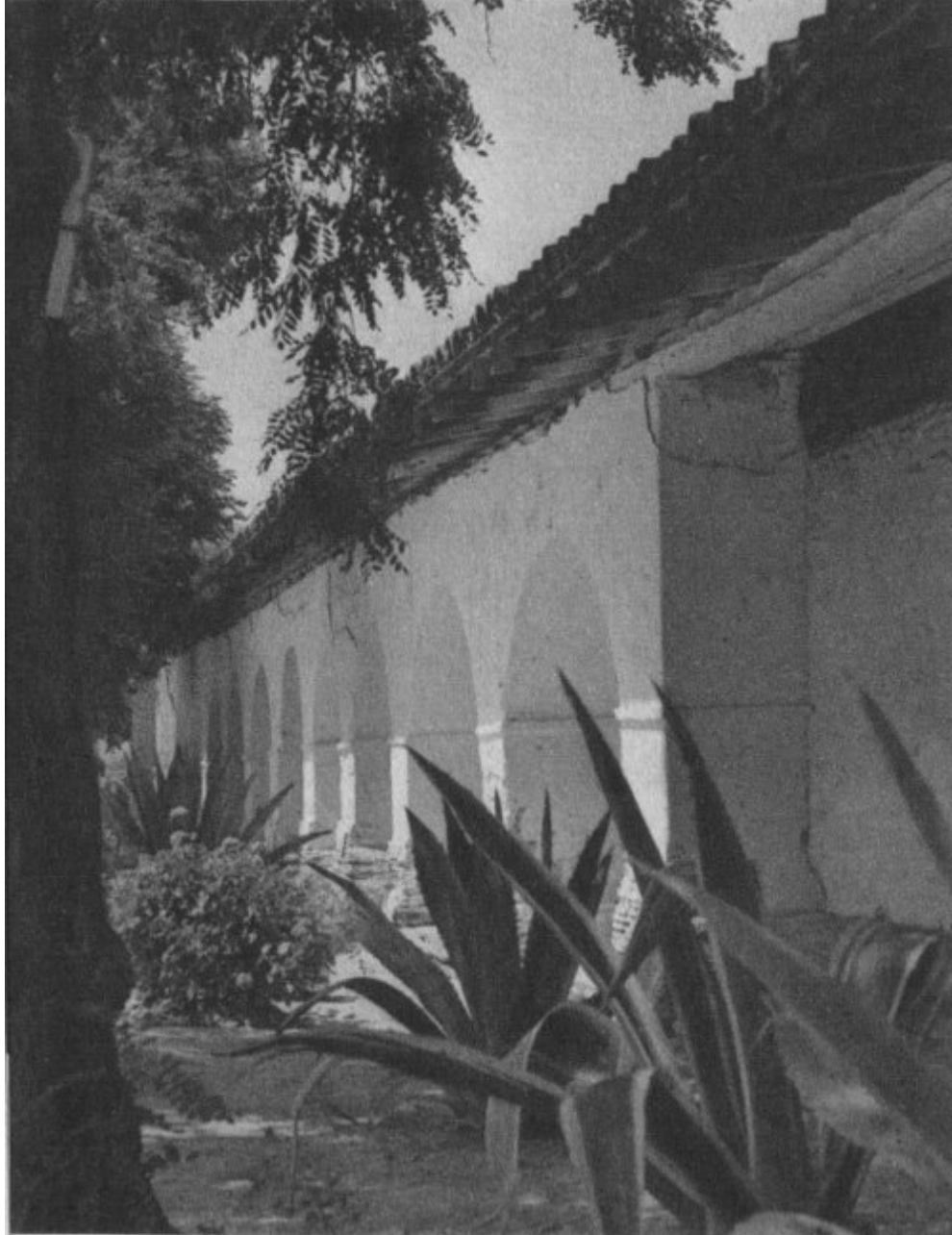
End of Cloister



Garden, San Juan Bautista



Cemetery at San Juan Bautista



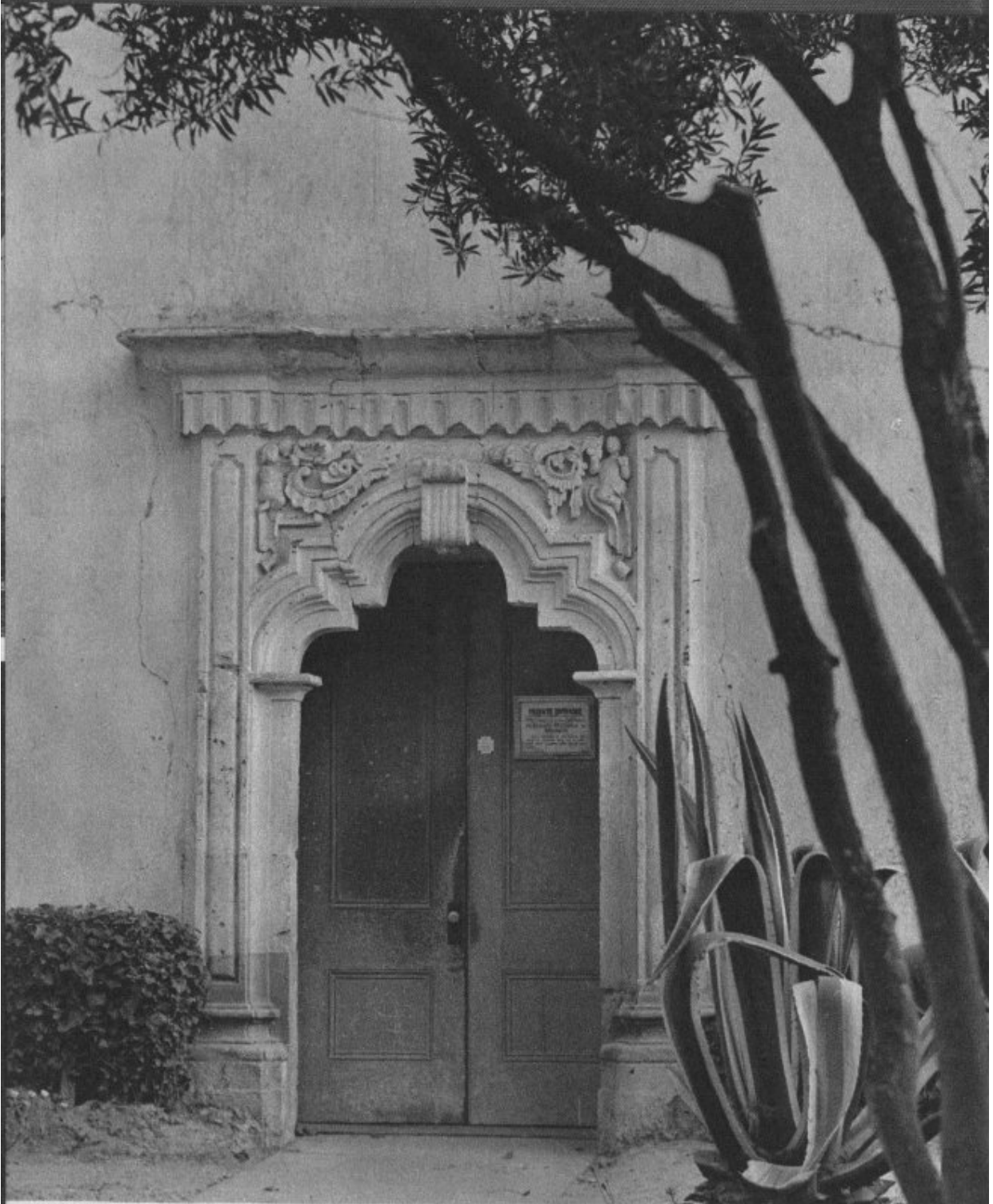
Arches

On the site of Mission Santa Clara de Asís stands a concrete structure, the chapel of the University of Santa Clara. All that remains of the old buildings are a few tiles in the roof, and a part of the garden wall. In front of the Church stands the old redwood cross, raised in 1777. It is now encased in a sheathing of pine.



Parish Church, Monterey

Mission San José de Guadalupe was at one time the most prosperous of all the missions. In livestock alone it had 12,000 cattle, 13,000 horses and 13,000 sheep. It was the centre of social life for the surrounding ranches and the stopping place for the Forty-niners who used the Mission Pass between San Francisco and the mines. Only a part of the living quarters remains today. Beside this building is the old cemetery, back of which is the Mission garden.



Doorway, Monterey



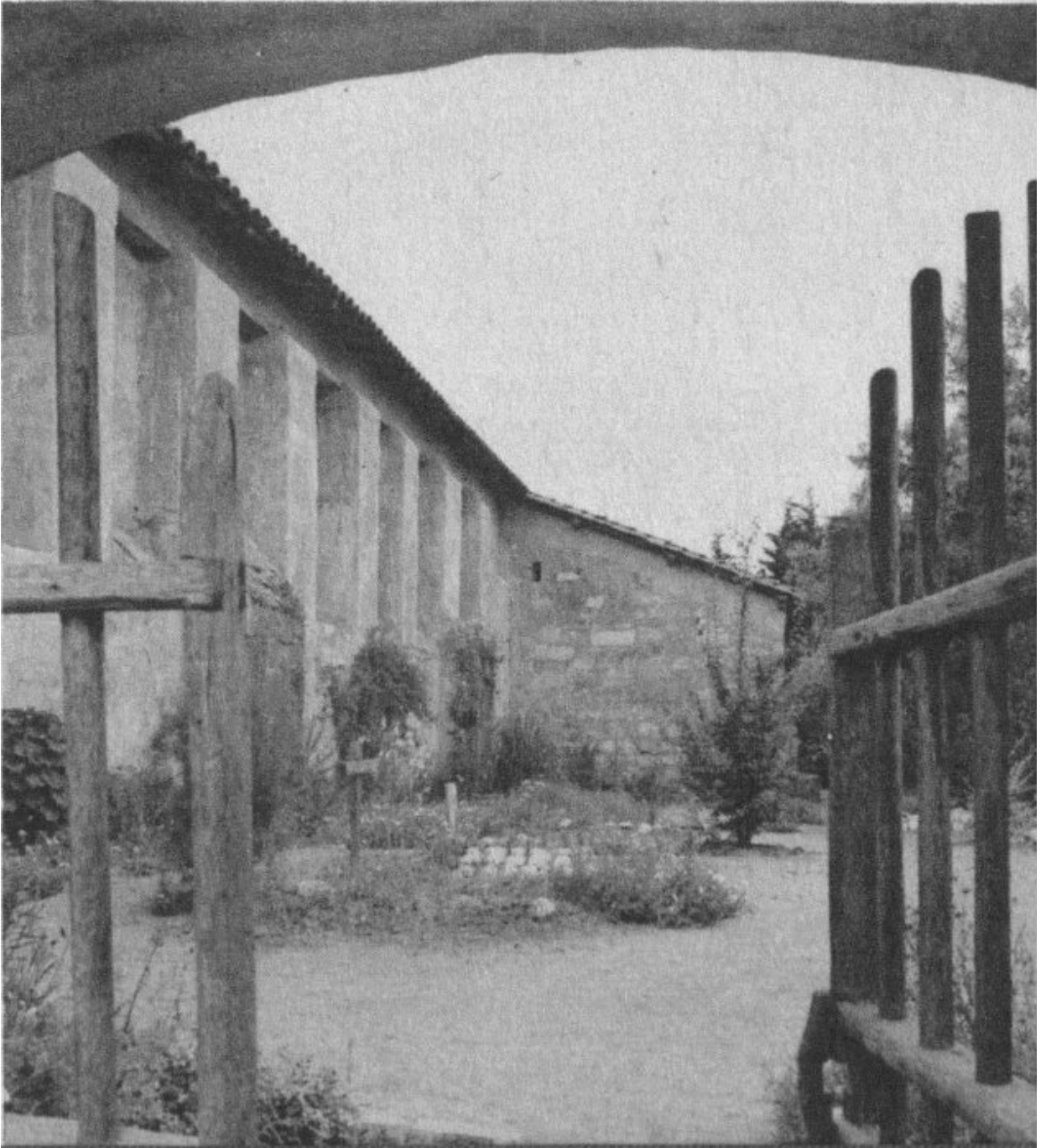
San Carlos De Borromeo



Doorway, San Carlos De Borromeo



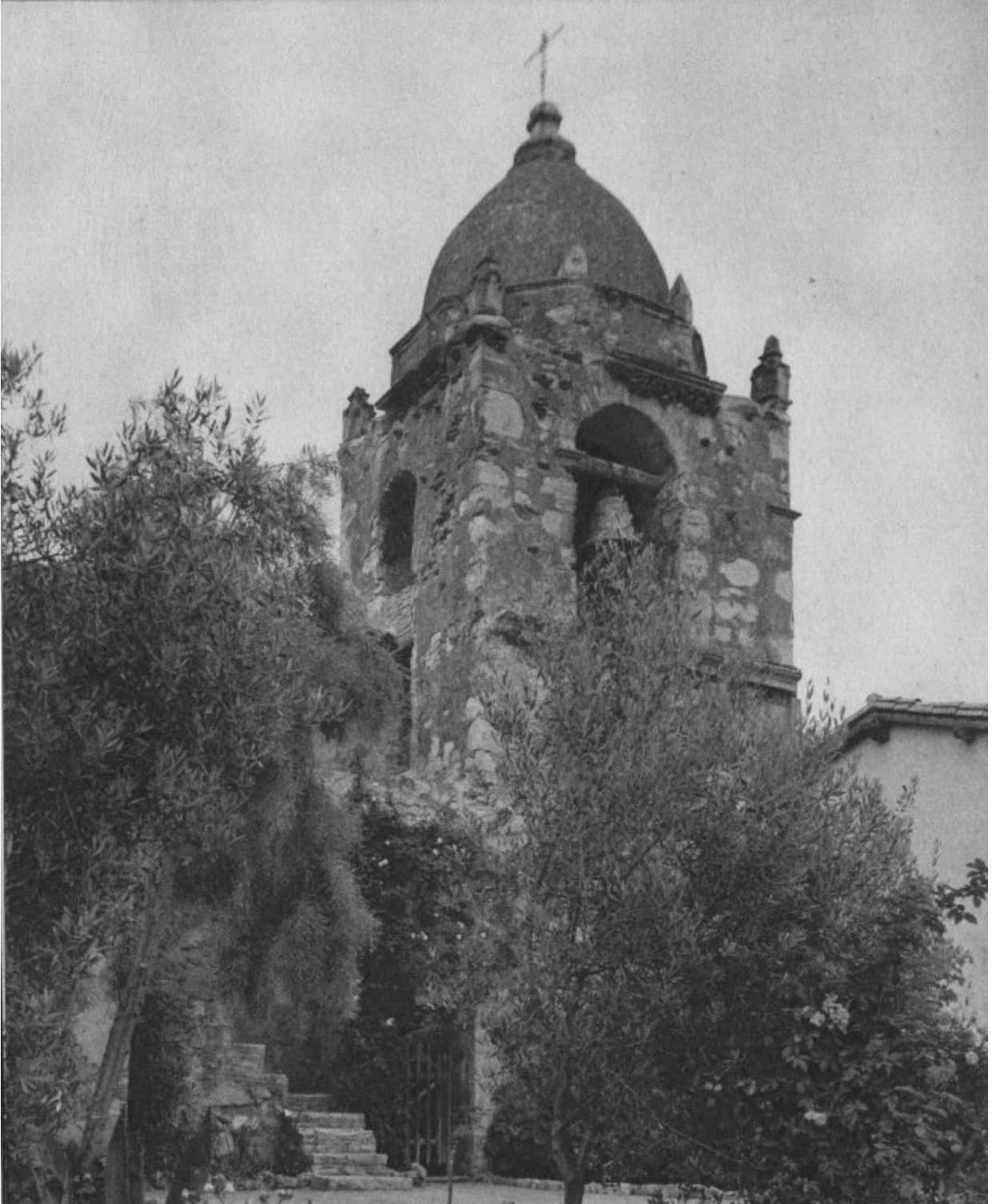
Fountain Detail



Gateway to Cemetery

There was nothing in the original plans of the missions to name one after St. Francis, the founder of the Franciscan Order. The Mexican Visitador said, "If Saint Francis wishes a mission, let him show you a good port, and let it bear his name." When Portolá discovered San Francisco Bay he decided that it was the place the Visitador meant, but it was not until seven years later

that the Mission San Francisco de Asís was founded. It was commonly called Dolores after a small river that flowed through the Mission grounds. It is quite different in its architecture from the other missions. It has neither archway nor towers but a massive façade. Today it stands in quiet simplicity, surrounded on all sides by modern buildings of the Catholic Church.

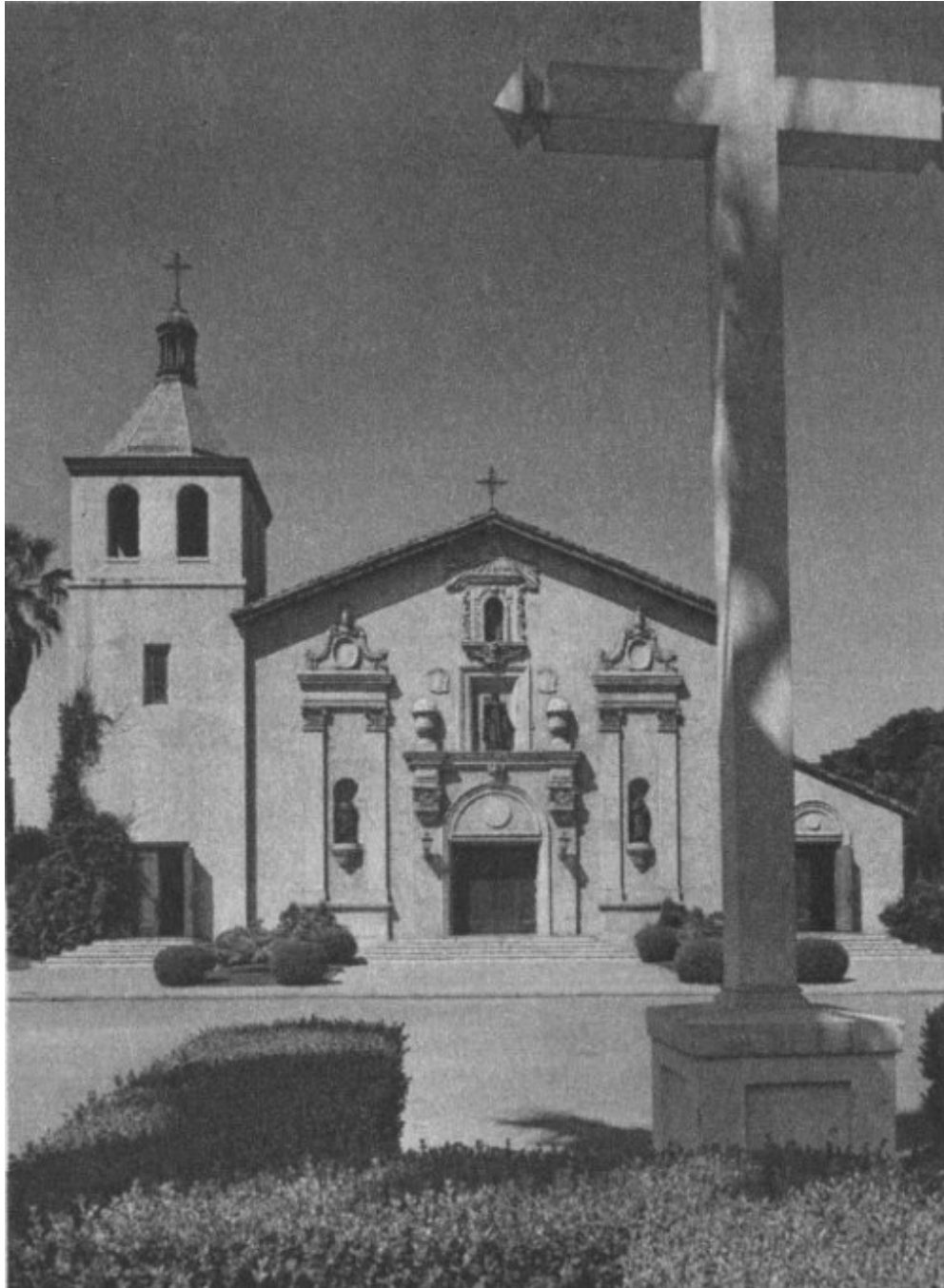


Bell Tower, San Carlos De Borromeo



Santa Cruz

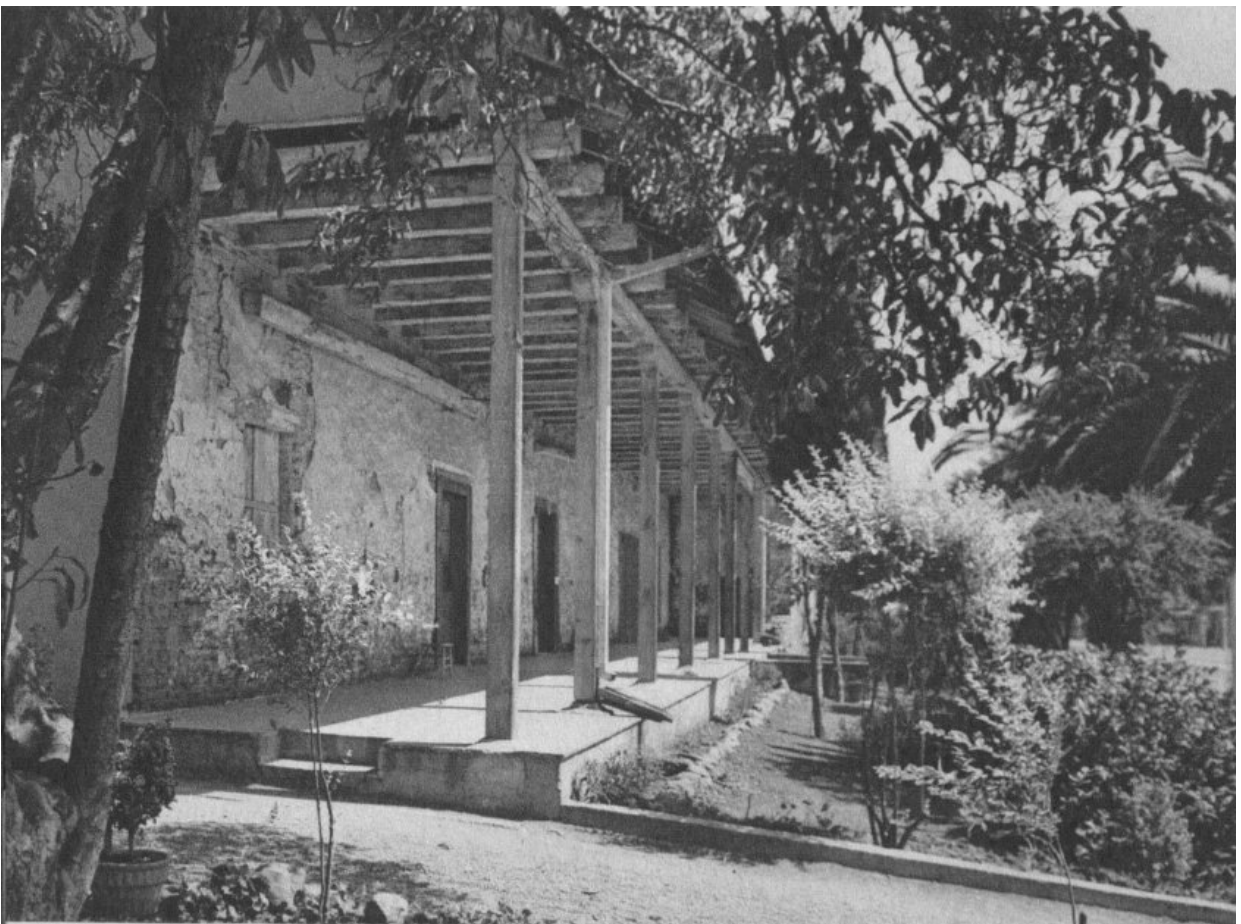
In the city of San Rafael stands a mission bell guidepost, marking the site of Mission San Rafael Arcángel.



Santa Clara



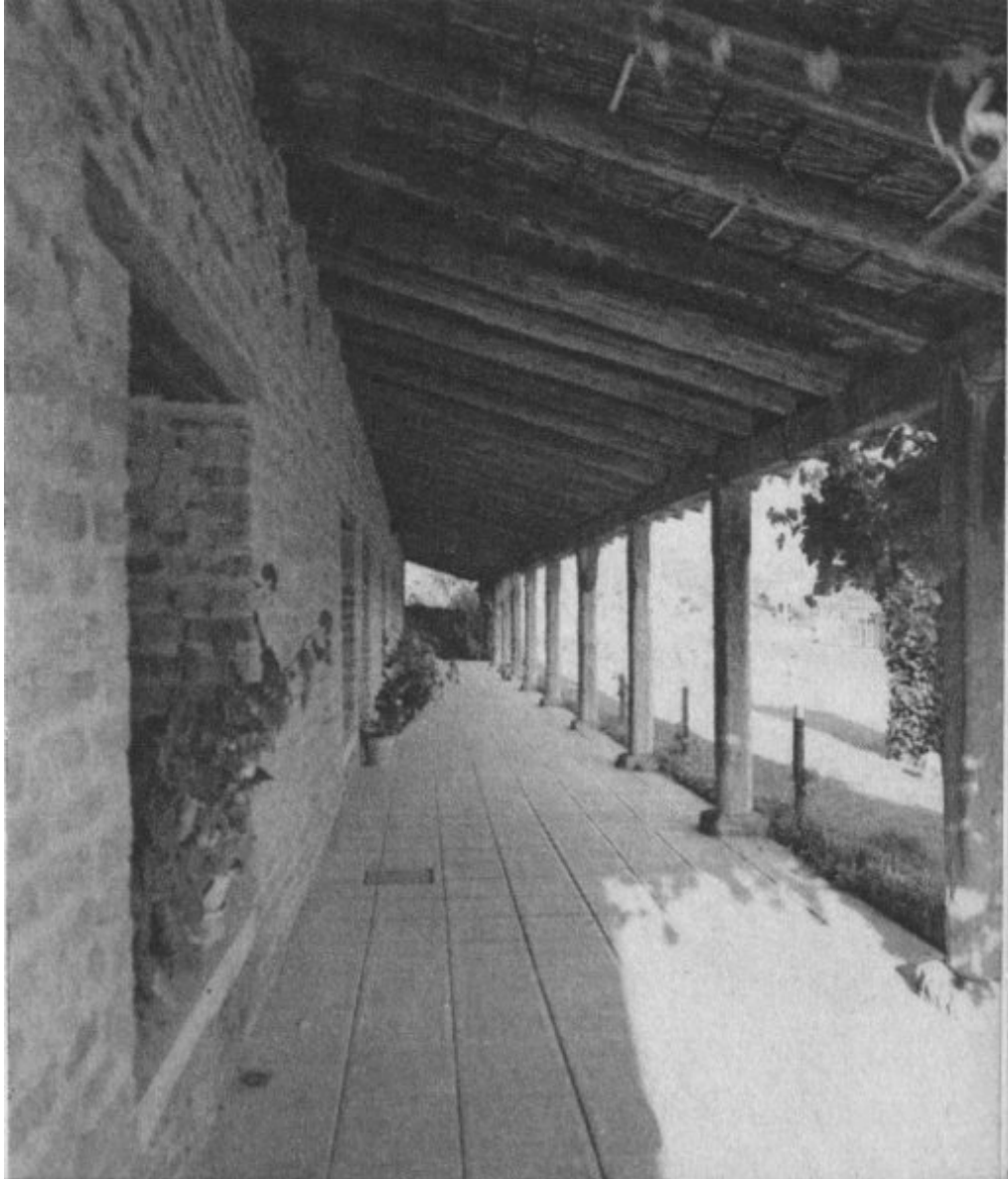
San José De Guadalupe



Porch



San Francisco De Asís

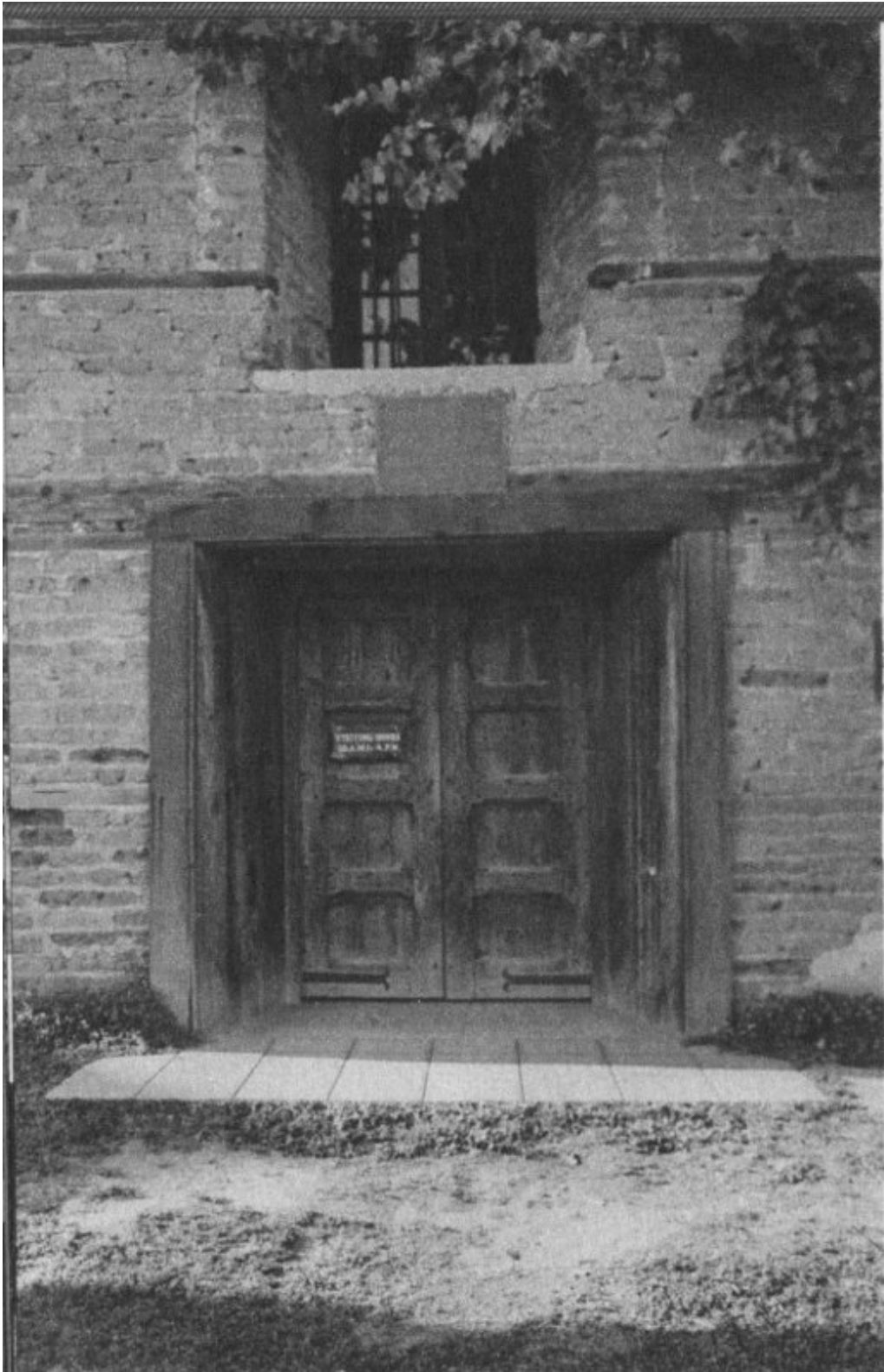


Entrance to Cloister

Fear of the Russians caused the Governor to ask Father Altimira to establish a mission at Sonoma. He did this without the sanction of the Church authorities. Mission San Francisco Solano was the last and the most northerly of the twenty-one missions. It is a plain low building, facing the plaza. 62

Of the twenty-one missions originally built one is completely gone, another a crumbling wall of adobe, and the remainder in only partial restoration. May they all some day be restored to their original grandeur, and

the romance and history of Old California again be found in their splendid old walls.



Entrance to Chapel



Cloister, San Francisco De Solano

LOCATION OF MISSIONS IN THE ORDER OF THEIR FOUNDING

NAME	DATE	LOCATION
San Diego de Alcalá	<i>July 16, 1769</i>	In Mission Valley six miles N.W. of San Diego.
San Carlos Borromeo	<i>June 3, 1770</i>	On the outskirts of village of Carmel which is five miles from Monterey.
San Antonio de Padua	<i>July 14, 1771</i>	Six miles from Jolon. Jolon is twenty miles from King City. Can also be reached from San Simeon Highway over very mountainous road. Advise going by way of King City.
San Gabriel Arcángel	<i>Sept. 8, 1771</i>	In city of San Gabriel which is 10 miles from Los Angeles.
San Luis Obispo de Tolosa	<i>Sept. 1, 1772</i>	In centre of city of San Luis Obispo.
San Francisco de Asís (Mission Dolores)	<i>June 29, 1776</i>	In San Francisco at 16th and Dolores Streets.
San Juan Capistrano	<i>Nov. 1, 1776</i>	In village of San Juan Capistrano which is 65 miles south of Los Angeles on the highway to San Diego.
Santa Clara de Asis	<i>Jan. 12, 1777</i>	In the grounds of the University of Santa Clara which is in the city of Santa Clara.
San Buenaventura	<i>March 31, 1782</i>	Located in city of Ventura which is 60 miles north of Los Angeles.
Santa Barbara	<i>Dec. 4, 1786</i>	In the city of Santa Barbara.

La Purísima Concepción	<i>Dec. 8, 1787</i>	Five miles north of town of Lompoc.
Santa Cruz	<i>Aug. 28, 1791</i>	In city of Santa Cruz.
Soledad	<i>Oct. 9, 1791</i>	Ruins of this Mission are about two miles from the town of Soledad.
San José	<i>June 11, 1797</i>	About 15 miles north of San Jose on the Oakland Highway.
San Juan Bautista	<i>June 24, 1797</i>	In town of San Juan Bautista.
San Miguel Arcángel	<i>July 25, 1797</i>	Ten miles north of Paso Robles on U.S. 101.
San Fernando Rey	<i>Sept. 8, 1797</i>	On outskirts of town of San Fernando.
San Luis Rey	<i>June 13, 1798</i>	Five miles east of town of Oceanside.
Santa Inéz	<i>Sept. 17, 1804</i>	Three miles east of town of Buellton.
San Rafael Arcángel	<i>Dec. 14, 1817</i>	Nothing remains of Mission. Site now marked by guidepost in city of San Rafael.
San Francisco Solano	<i>July 4, 1823</i>	In city of Sonoma, thirty miles north of San Francisco.
Pala	<i>1816</i>	Twenty-one miles from Mission San Luis Rey in the village of Pala at base of Palomar Mountain.
Royal Presidio Chapel	<i>June 3, 1770</i>	In city of Monterey.



Transcriber's Notes

- Copyright notice provided as in the original—this e-text is public domain in the country of publication.
- Silently corrected palpable typos; left non-standard spellings and dialect unchanged.
- Moved some captions closer to the corresponding pictures.
- In the text versions, delimited italicized text by underscores.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK CALIFORNIA
MISSIONS: A GUIDE TO THE HISTORIC TRAILS OF THE PADRES

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